

# Progress at the 5th post-Minkowskian Order in Gravitational-Wave Physics

Zvi Bern

June 18, 2026

Theoretical Developments of Gravitational Wave Physics  
Yukawa Institute, Kyoto



ZB, E. Herrmann, R. Roiban, M. Ruf, V.A. Smirnov, A.V. Smirnov, M. Zeng:  
arXiv:2305.08981, arXiv:2406.01554; arXiv:2509.17412

ZB, E. Herrmann, R. Roiban, M. Ruf, A.V. Smirnov, S. Smith, M. Zeng: arXiv:2512.15383.

ZB, Jackman, Mansfield, Ruf: ArXiv:2603.15283.



**Mani L. Bhaumik**  
Institute for Theoretical Physics



Funded by  
the European Union

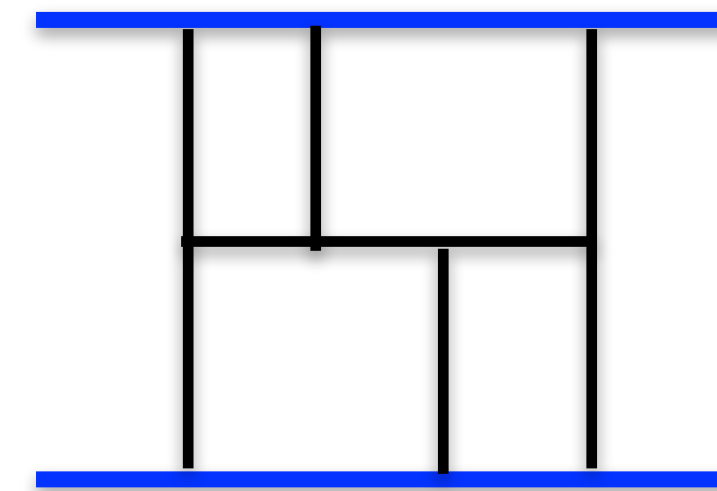


European Research Council  
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# Outline

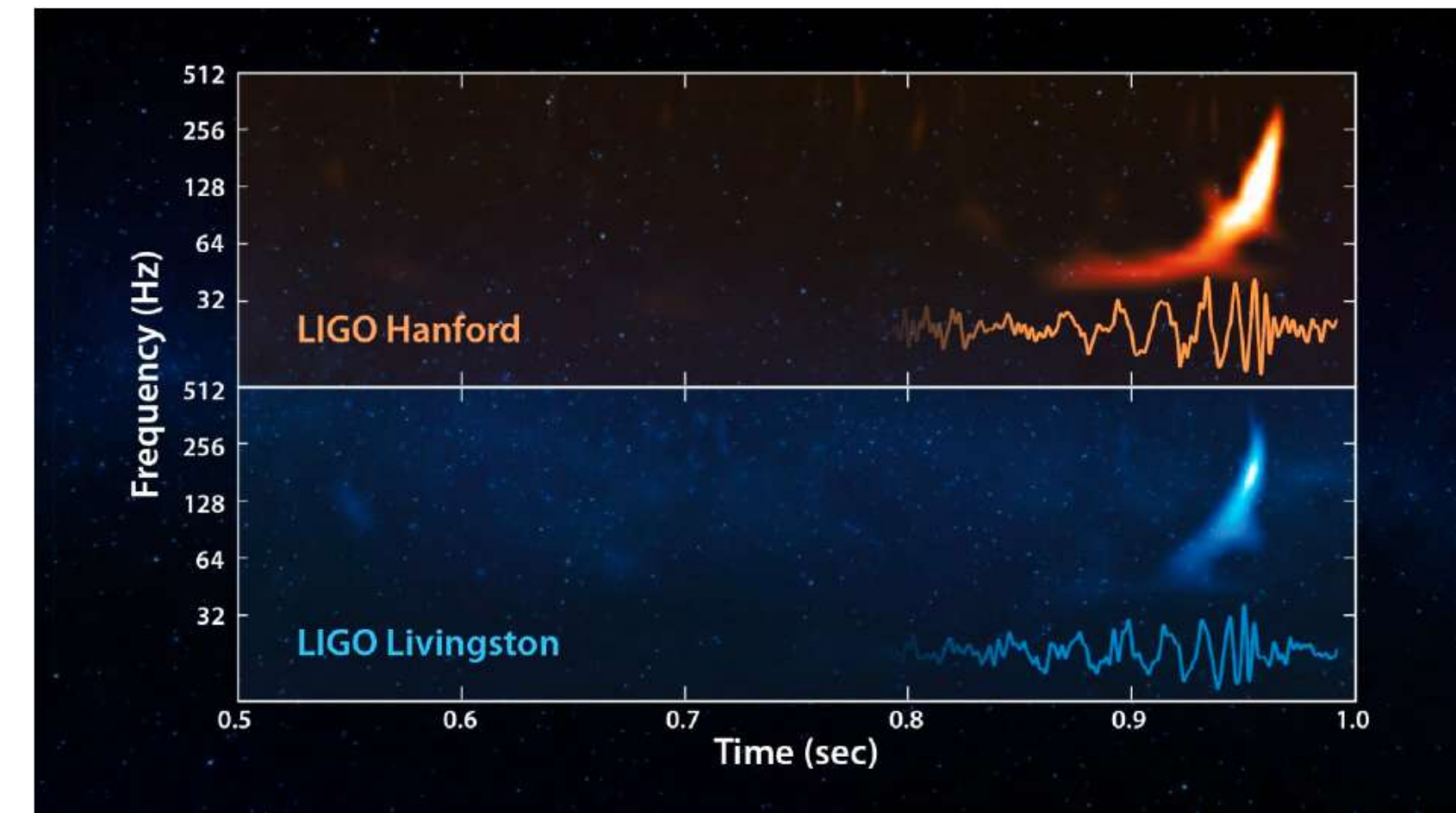
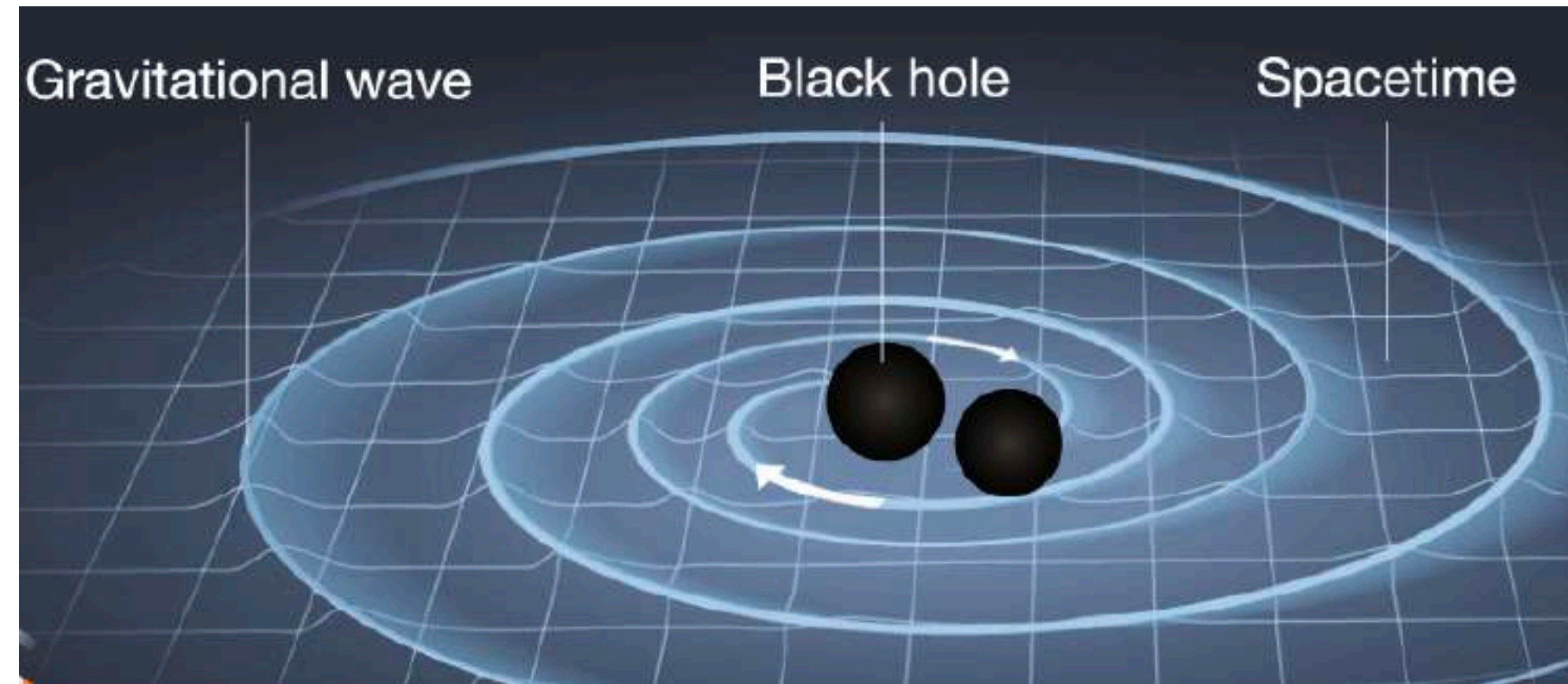
1. Summary of the problem and PM approach.
2. Brief review of basics:
  - Quantum scattering amplitudes and gravity.
  - Unitarity as a tool.
  - Double copy relations between gravity and gauge theory.
2. Applications to state-of-the-art precision gravitational-wave computations.
3. Update on  $O(G^5)$
4. Conclusions and outlook.



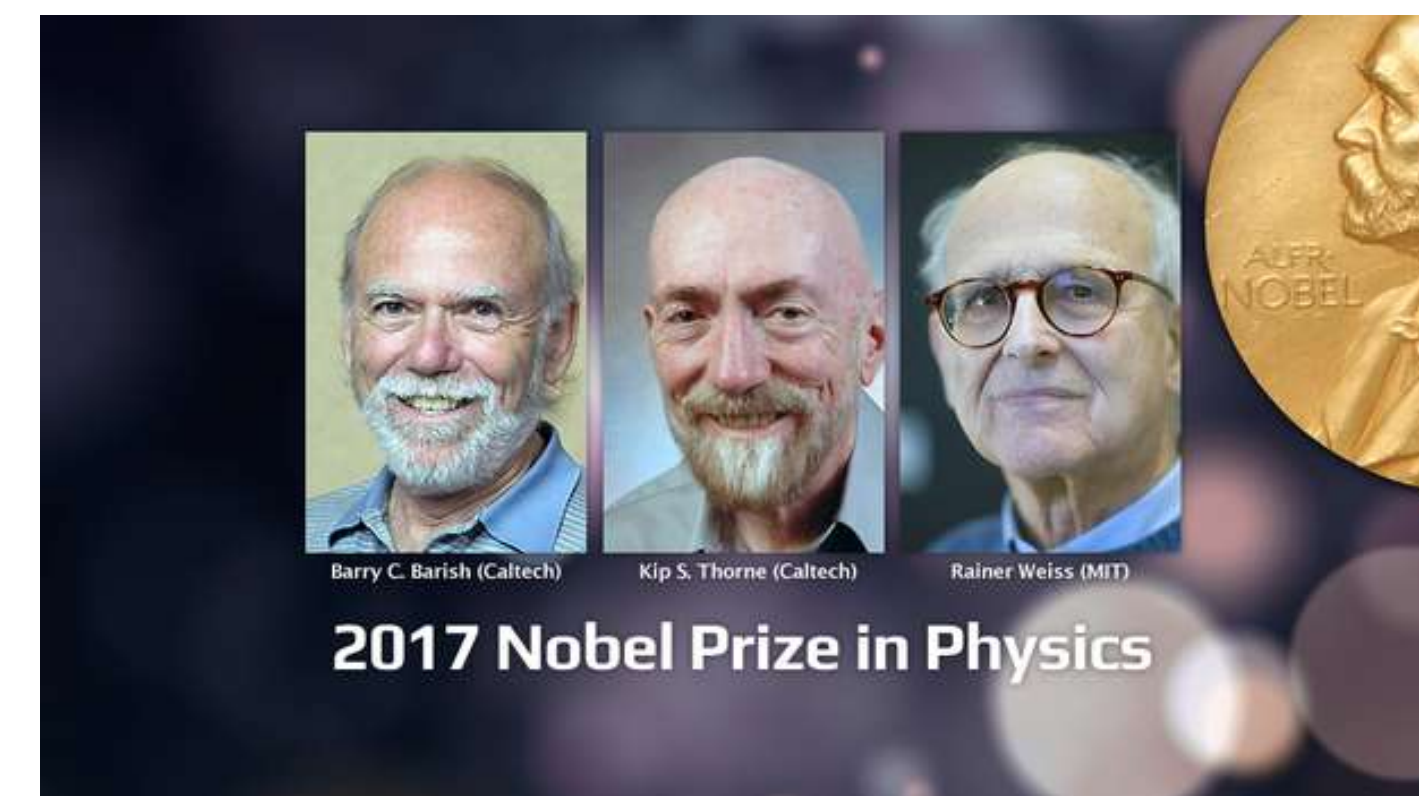


# Gravitational Waves

## Era of gravitational-wave astronomy



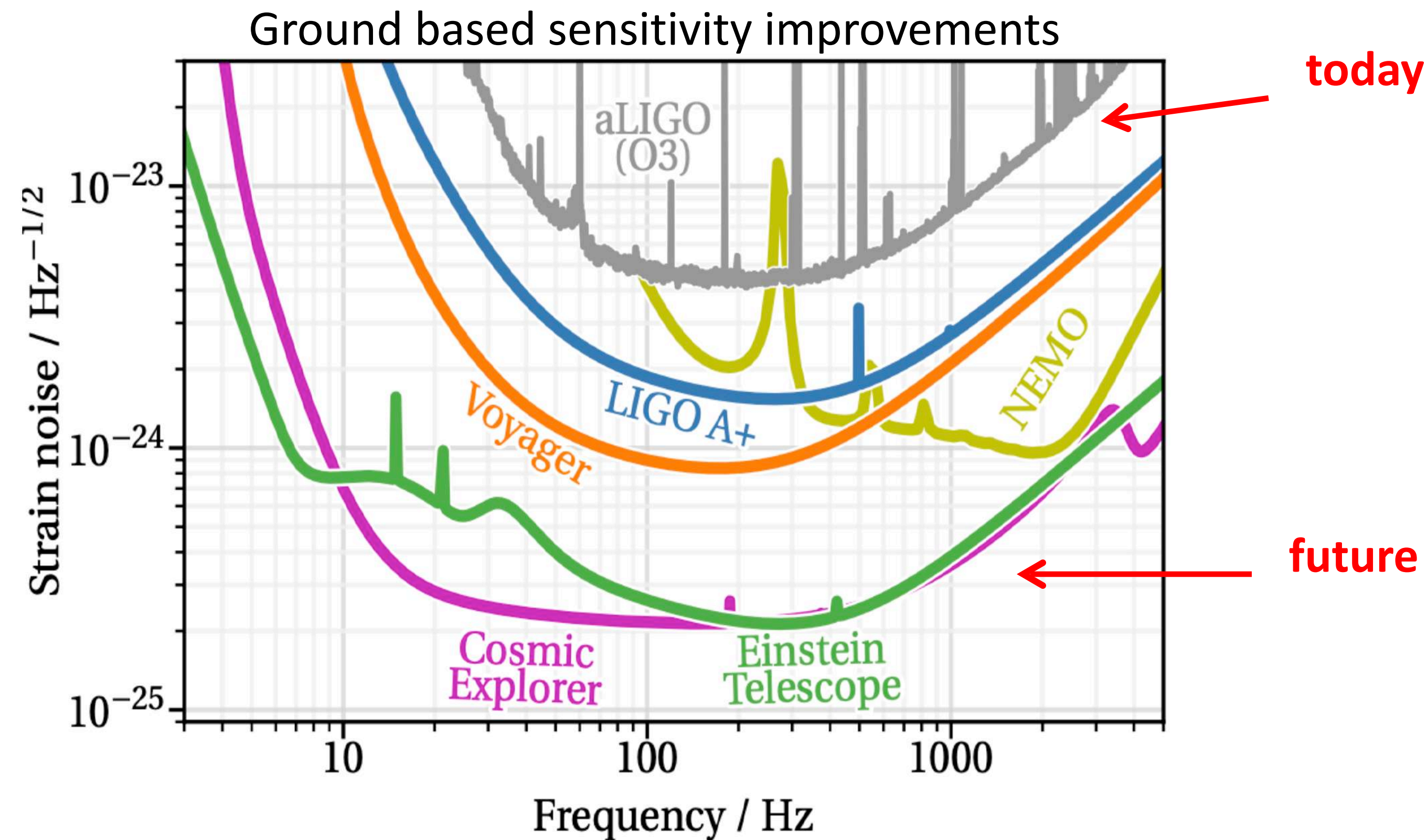
LIGO Detectors



How can we, as particle physicists, help?



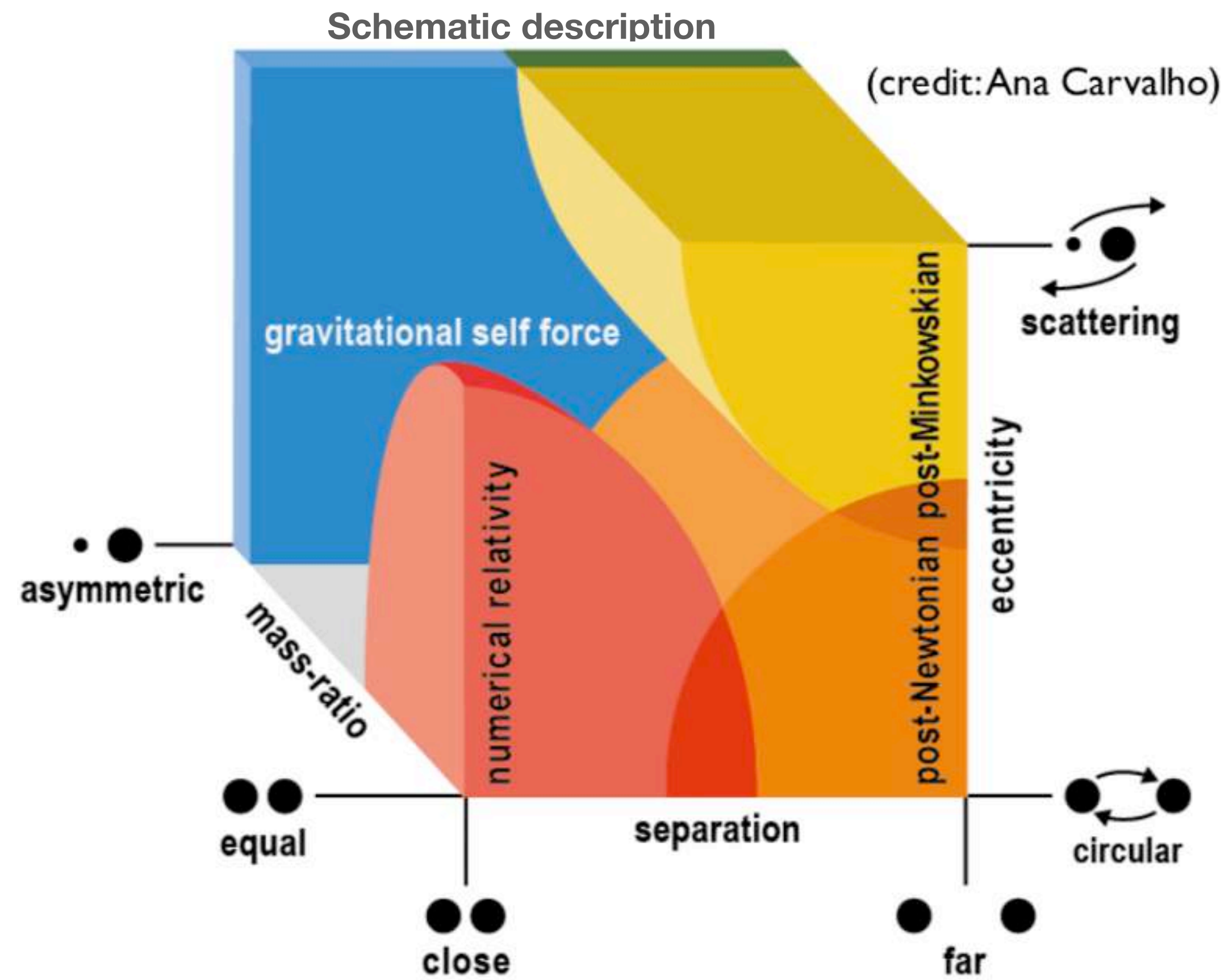
# Increased Sensitivity of Detectors



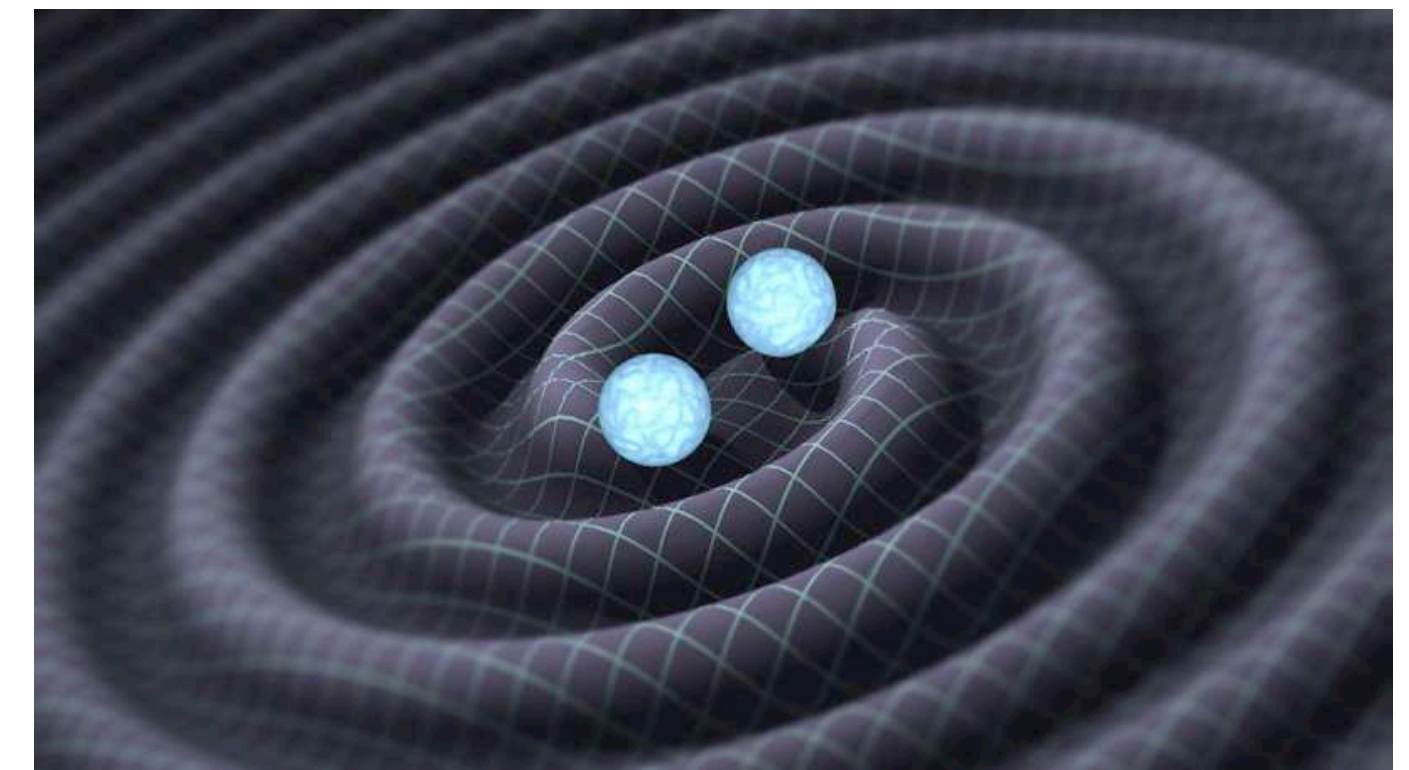
<https://cosmicexplorer.org/sensitivity.html>

- Factor of 100 increase in sensitivity in some regions is coming.
- Also, space-based detectors at much lower frequencies.
- Highly nontrivial theory challenge. Two more orders in perturbation theory.

# Post-Minkowskian (PM) Approach



Scattering amplitudes fits naturally with post-Minkowskian approach



Many talks about the different approaches.

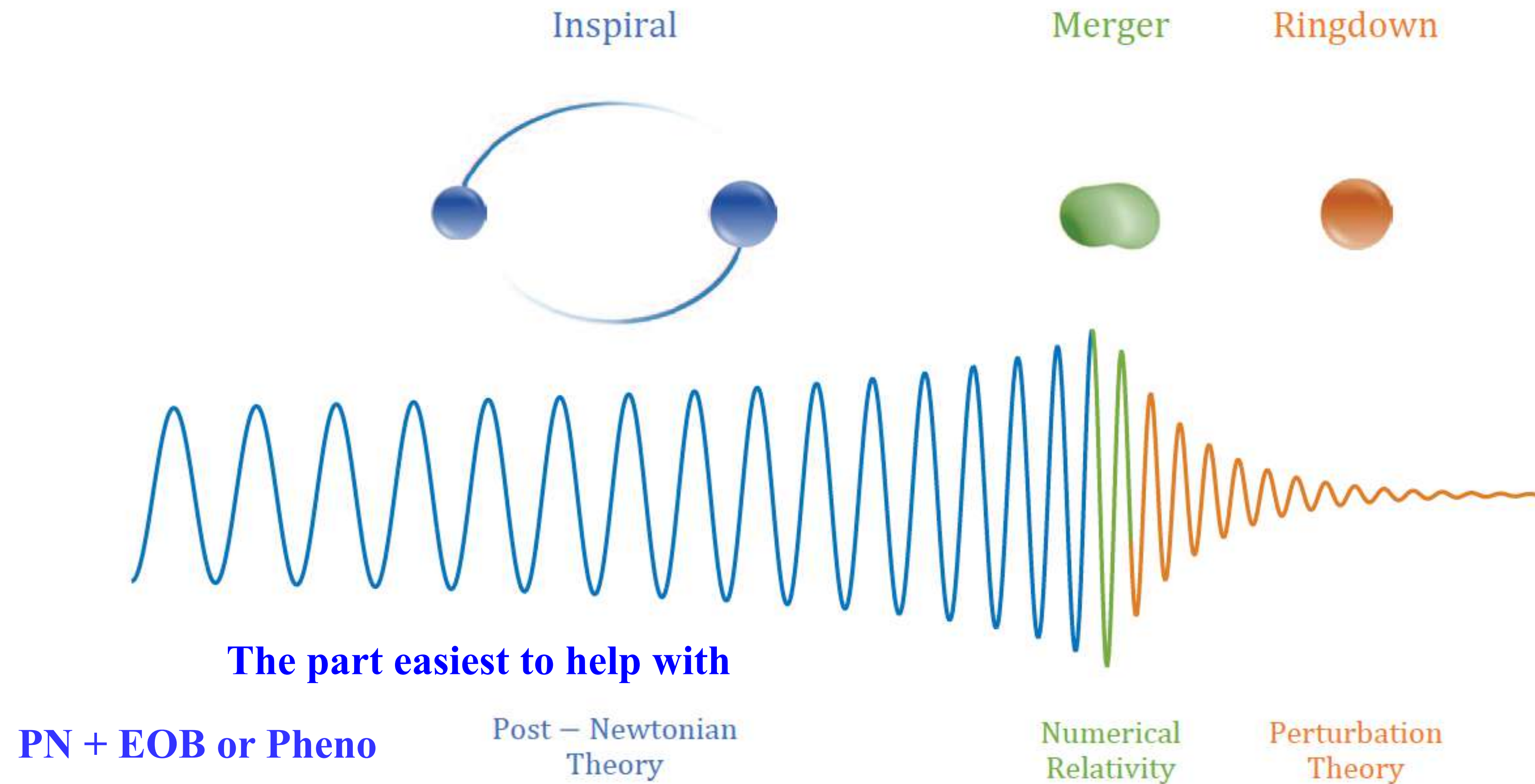
Different approximations are valid in different regions.

PM is an expansion in  $G$

Information needs to be combined into a unified (EOB) waveform model.



# Goal is to Improve Waveforms



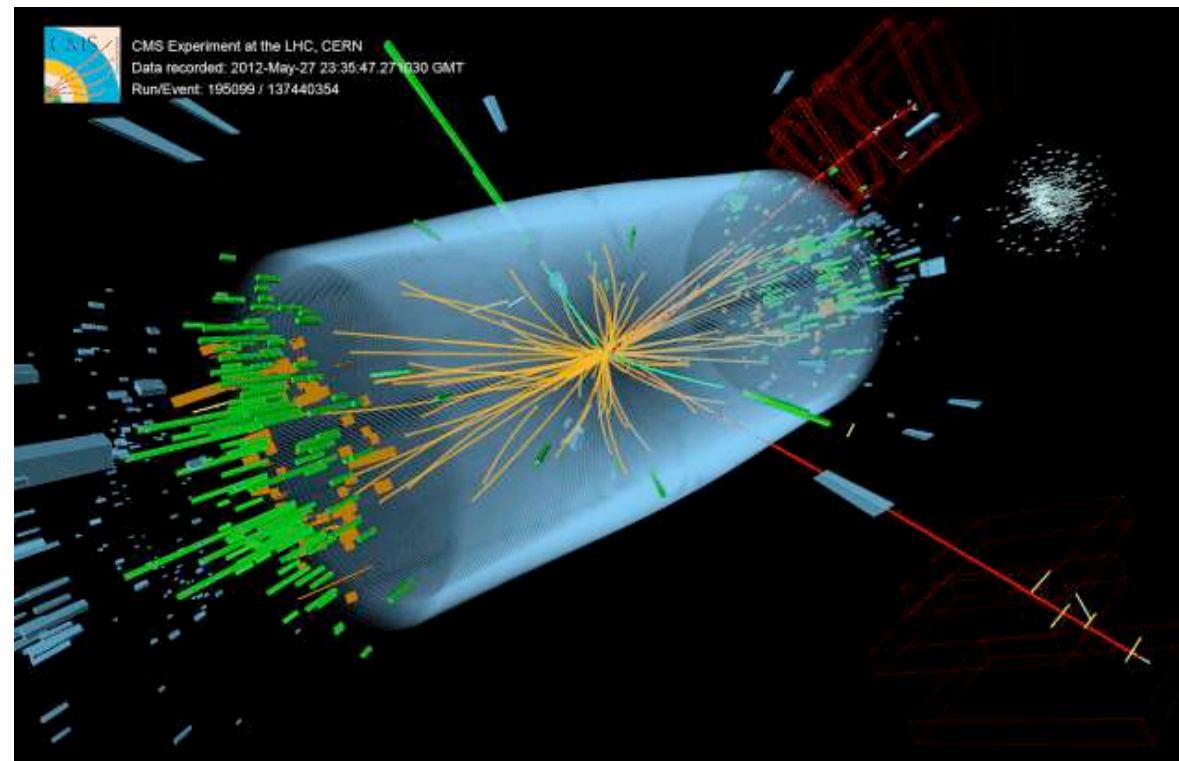
From Antelis and Moreno, arXiv:1610.03567

**Small errors accumulate. Need for high precision.**

# What do QFT Amplitudes have to do with Gravitational Waves?

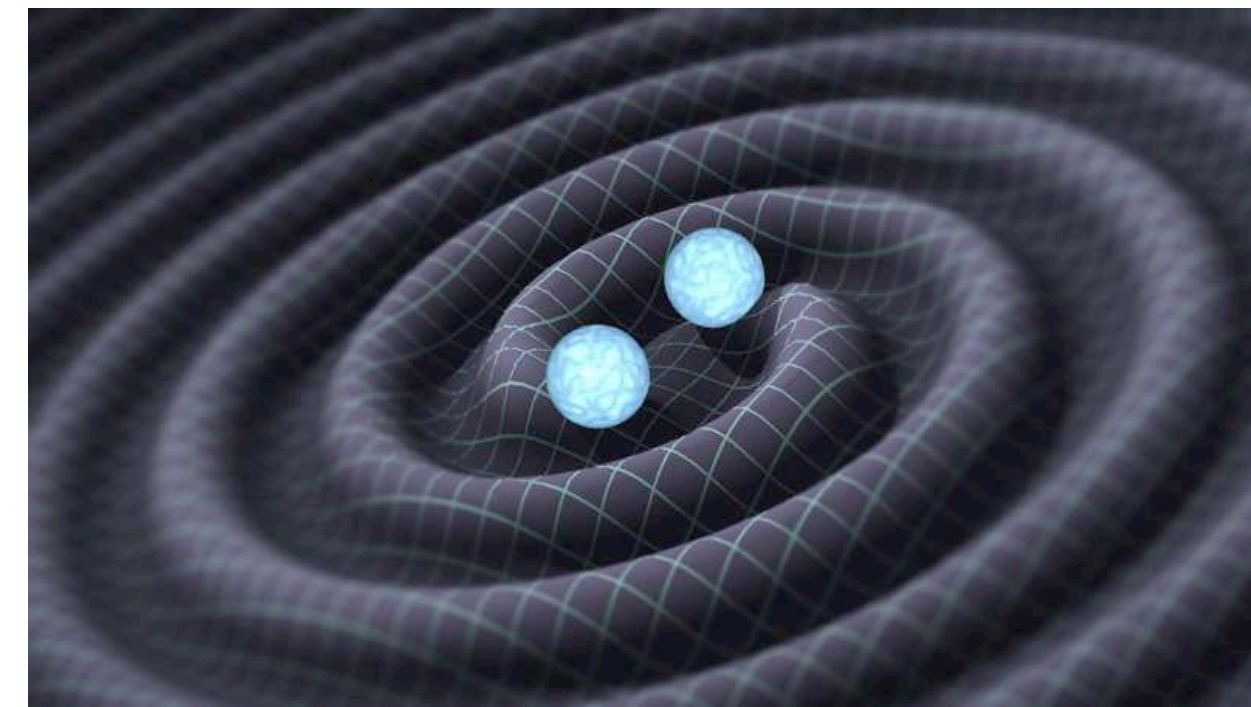
What does particle physics have to do with classical dynamics of astrophysical objects?

**unbounded trajectory**



**gauge theories, QCD, electroweak  
quantum field theory**

**bound orbit**



**General Relativity  
classical physics**

**Effective field theory ideas: Black holes and neutron stars are point particles as far as long-wavelength radiation is concerned.**

Iwasaki (1971); **Goldberger, Rothstein (2006)**; Neill and Rothstein; Vaydia, Foffa, Porto, Rothstein, Sturani; Kol; Bjerrum-Bohr, Donoghue, Holstein, Plante, Pierre Vanhove; Levi, Steinhoff; Vines etc



# Post-Minkowskian Approach

PM has a long history. Some highlights:

- **Kerr**, *The Lorentz-covariant approximation method in general relativity* (1959)
- **Bertotti and Plebanski**, *Theory of gravitational perturbations in the fast motion approximation* (1960)
- **Kovacs and Thorne**, *The generation of gravitational waves* (1977)
- **Westpfahl and Goller**, *Gravitational scattering of two relativistic particles in post-linear approximation* (1979)
- **Bel, Damour, Deruelle, Ibañez, Marti**, *Poincaré-invariant gravitational field and equations of motion of two pointlike objects: the postlinear approximation of general relativity* (1981)
- **Blanchet, Damour**, *Méthode d'itération post-minkowskienne et structure des champs gravitationnels radiatifs* (1984)
- **Damour**, *Gravitational scattering, post-Minkowskian approximation and effective one-body theory* (2016)
- **Damour**, *High energy gravitational scattering and the general relativistic two-body problem* (2017)

**In 2018 Modern scattering amplitudes methods brought to bear on the problem. First 3PM paper:**

- **Bern, Cheung, Roiban, Shen, Solon, Zeng**, *Scattering amplitudes and the conservative Hamiltonian for binary systems at third Post-Minkowskian order* (2019)

**Since then many PM papers: 3PM, 4PM, 5PM in progress.  
Topic of this talk.**



# High-energy gravitational scattering and the general relativistic two-body problem

Thibault Damour\*

*Institut des Hautes Etudes Scientifiques, 35 route de Chartres, 91440 Bures-sur-Yvette, France*

(Dated: October 31, 2017)



“... and we urge amplitude experts to use their novel techniques to compute the 2-loop scattering amplitude of scalar masses, from which one could deduce the third post-Minkowskian effective one-body Hamiltonian.”

tum gravitational scattering of two particles, and we urge amplitude experts to use their novel techniques to compute the 2-loop scattering amplitude of scalar masses, from which one could deduce the third post-Minkowskian effective one-body Hamiltonian



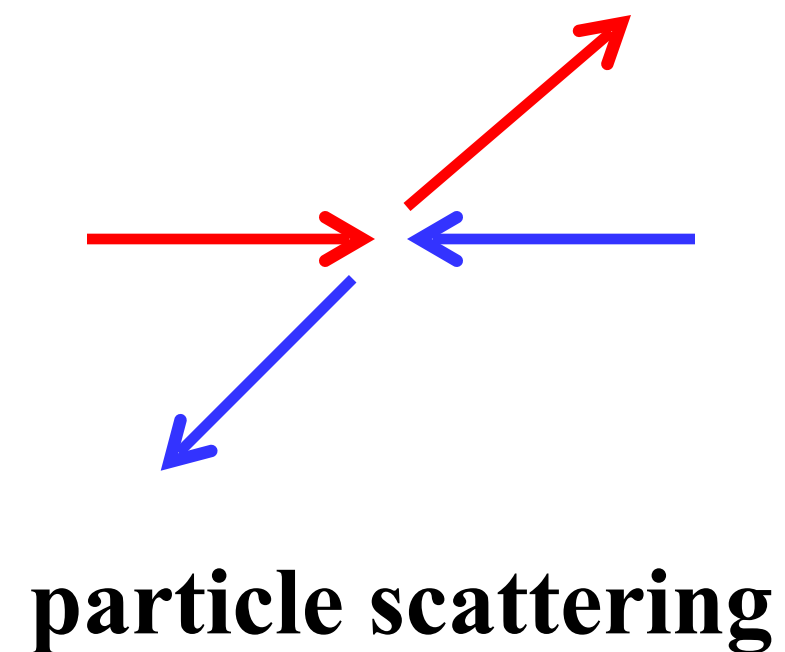
- August 2017, Alessandra Buonanno spoke at Current Themes in High Energy Physics and Cosmology Conference at Bohr Institute.
- December 2017, Alessandra came to QCD Meets Gravity at UCLA, to teach us about gravitational waves.
- June 2018, Alessandra came to Amplitudes 2018 at SLAC, again emphasizing 3 PM.

**PM is a natural arena for particle physics: “Perturbation theory”**

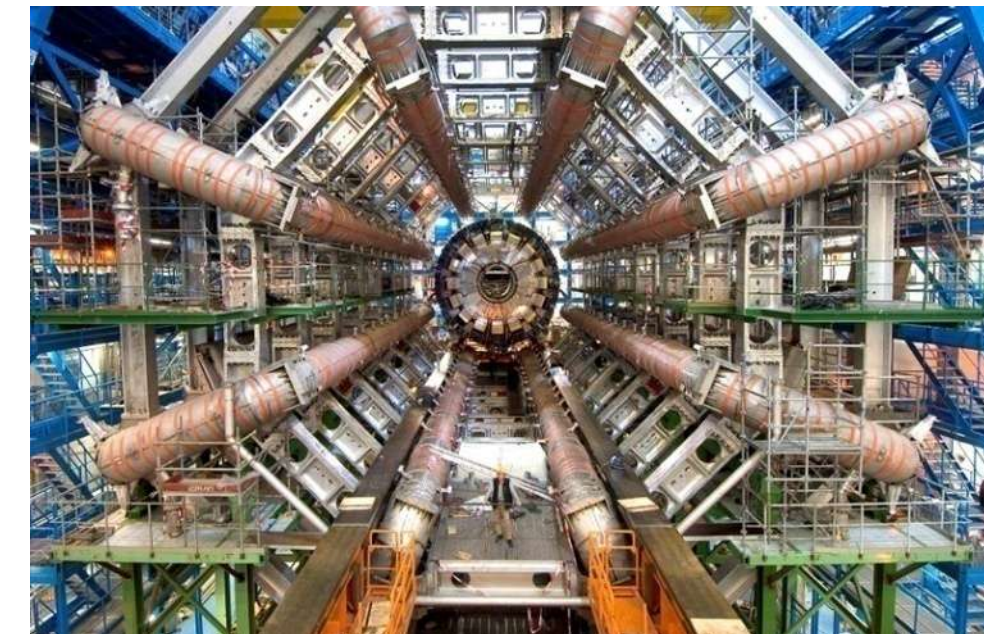


# Quantum Field Theory Scattering Amplitudes

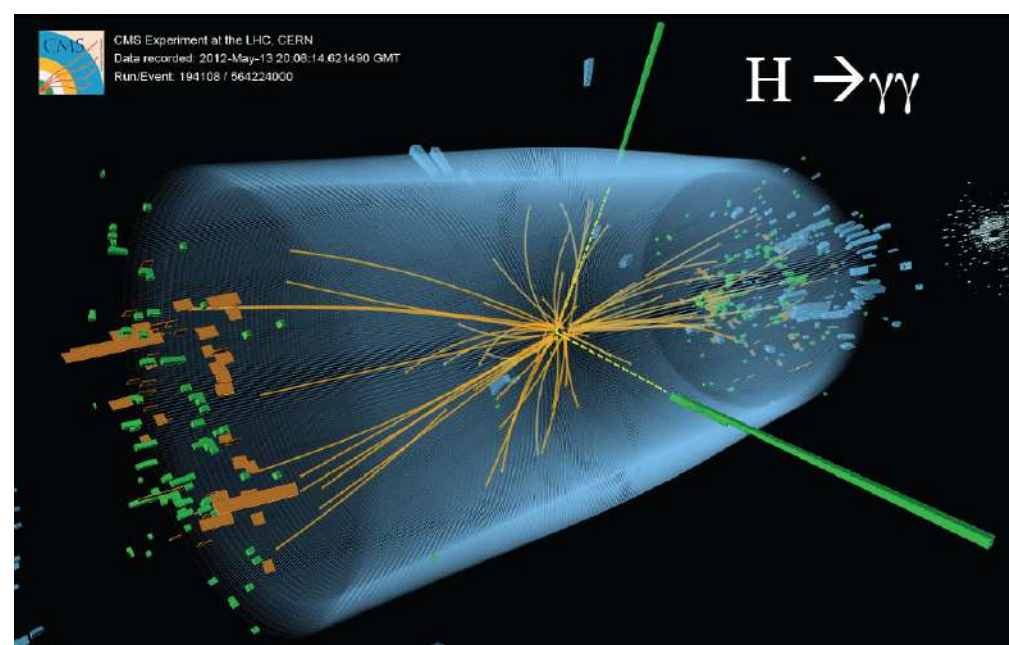
Scattering amplitudes give us quantum mechanical description of events at particle colliders.



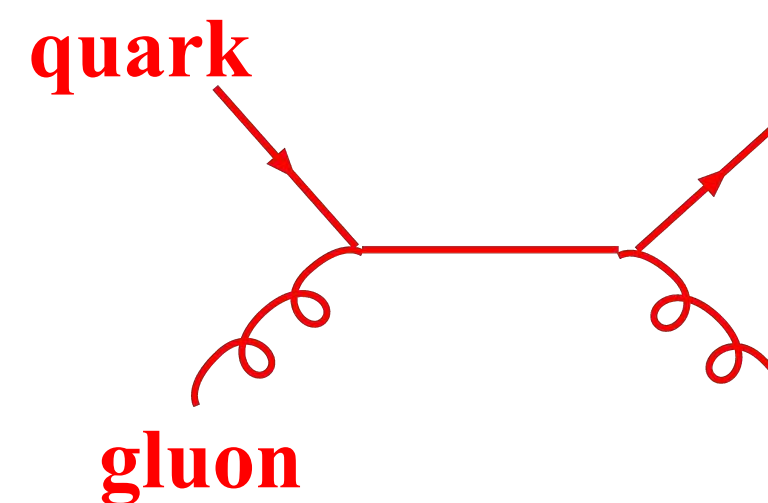
Large Hadron Collider



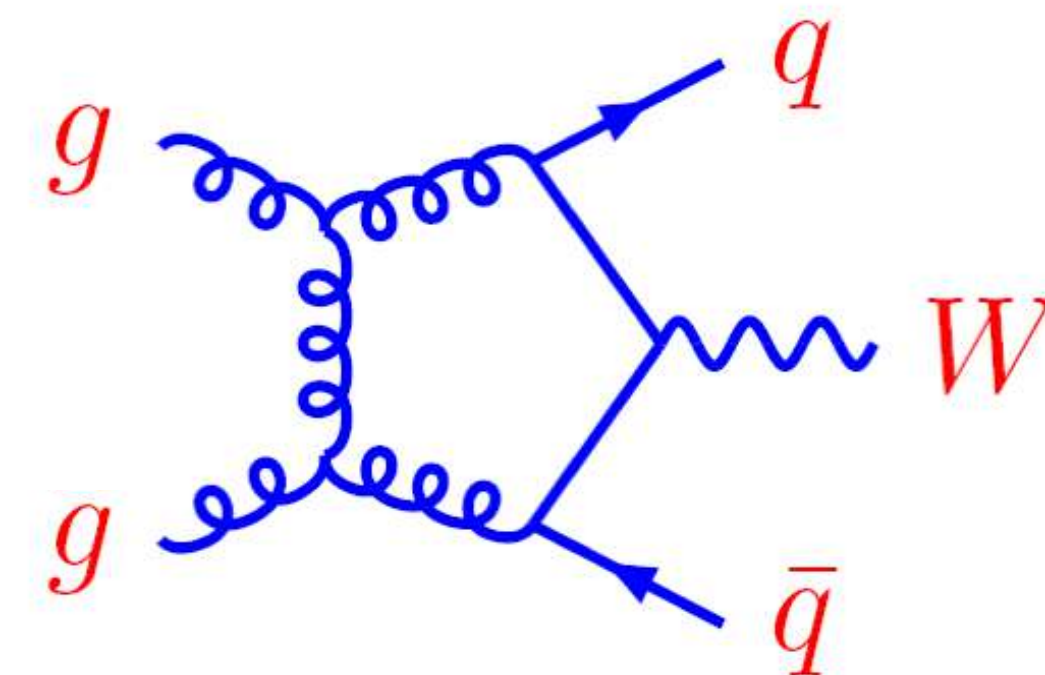
ATLAS Detector



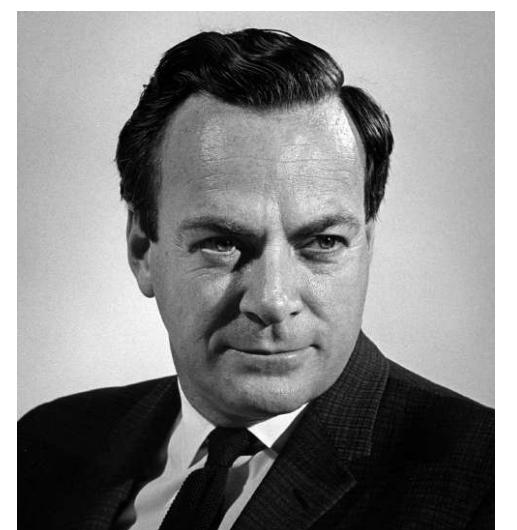
Higgs boson event



tree Feynman diagram



loop diagram  
higher order



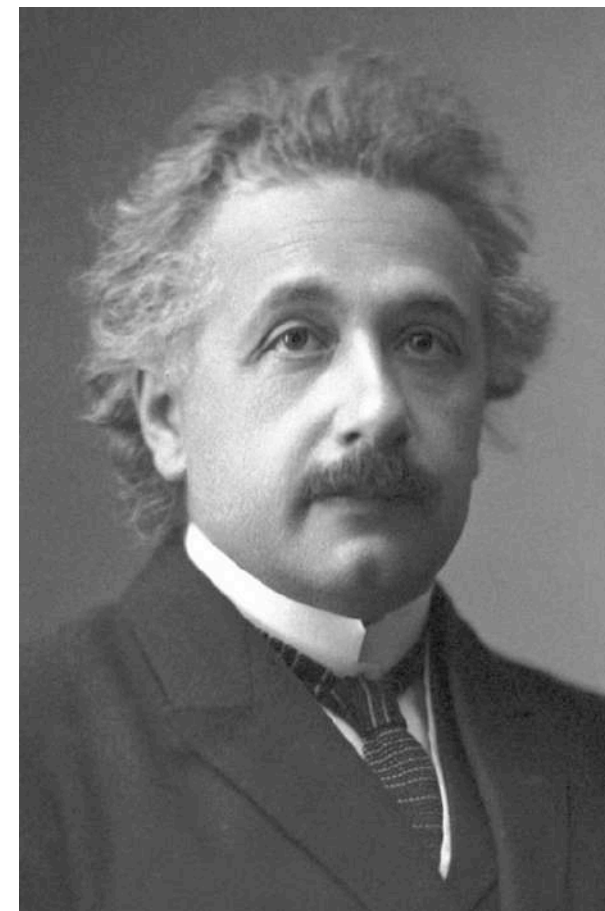
Scattering amplitudes provide a foundation for understanding particle collisions



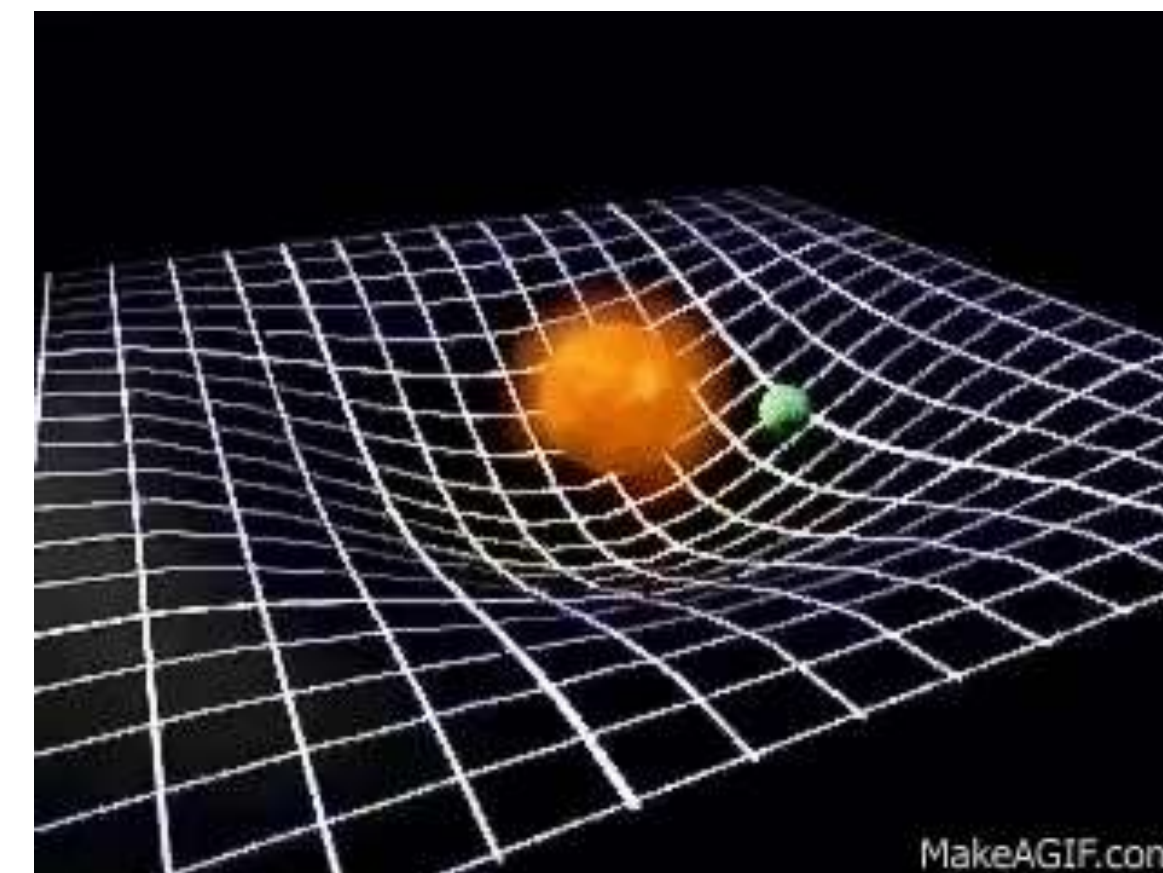
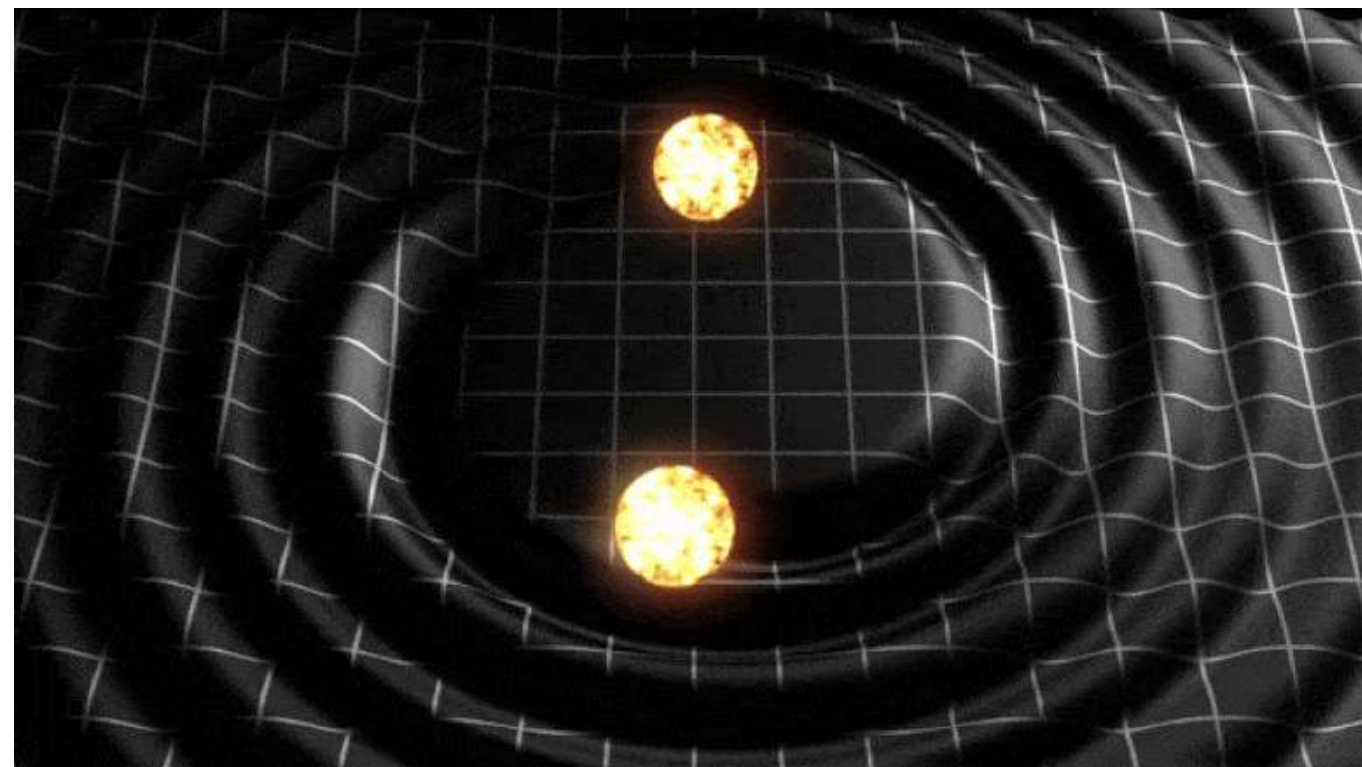
# General Relativity

Usually, people start from Einstein's field equations:

$$\overset{\text{curvature}}{\nearrow} R_{\mu\nu} - \frac{1}{2} R g_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi G T_{\mu\nu} \nwarrow \text{energy-momentum tensor}$$



**Geometry**  
**Curvature of space time**



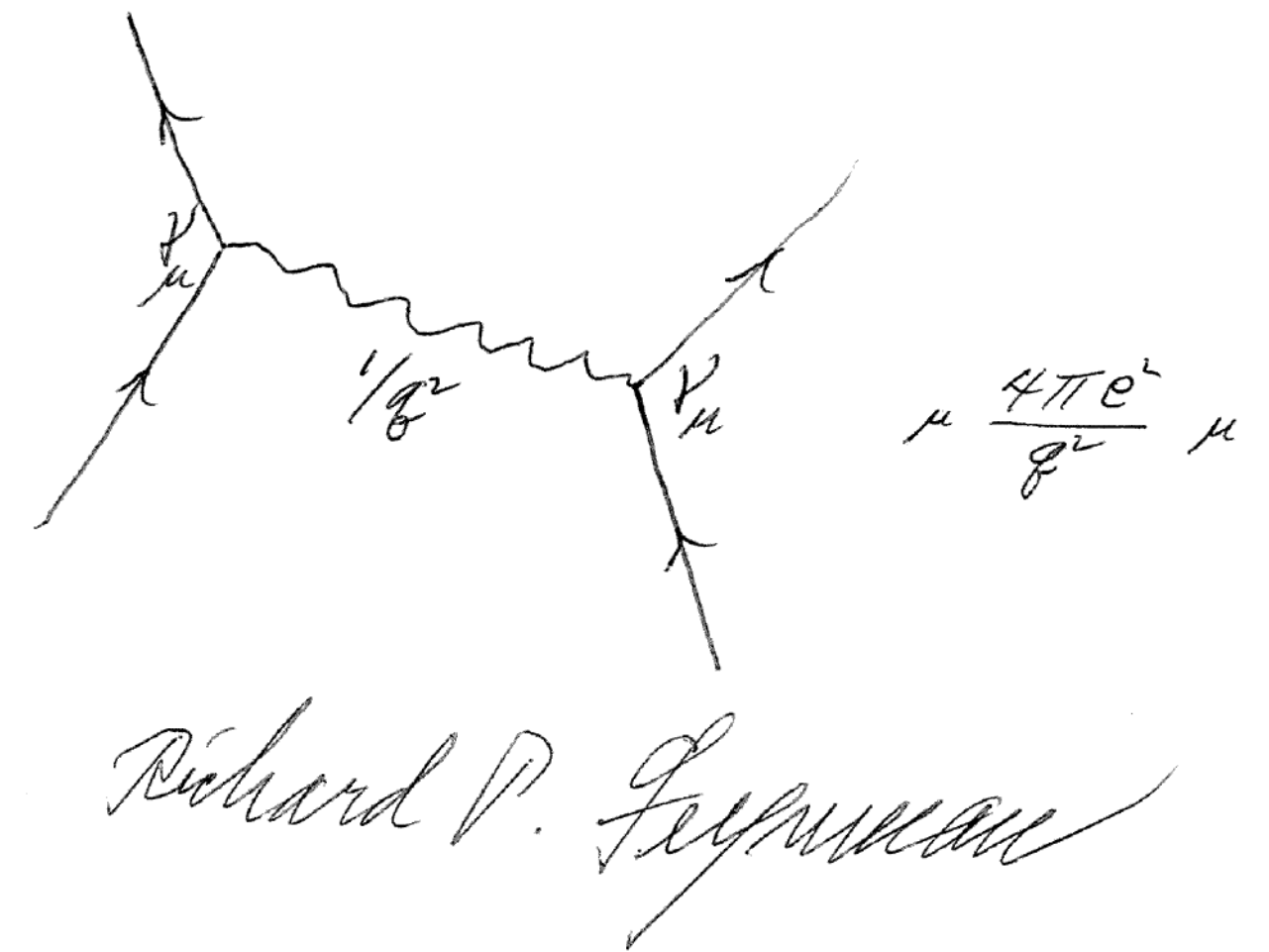


# Amplitudes Approach to General Relativity

Amplitudes approach does *not* start from Einstein's field equations.

$$\cancel{R_{\mu\nu} - \frac{1}{2}Rg_{\mu\nu} = 8\pi GT_{\mu\nu}}$$

**Feynman:** Einstein's gravity follows if we assume existence of massless spin-2 particle



**Our approach: Assume massless spin-2 gravitons exist**

Are gravitons real? No one knows for sure (no measurements).

**Whether real or not, we know for sure that they are useful!**

Not suitable for all problems but very effective for certain problems.

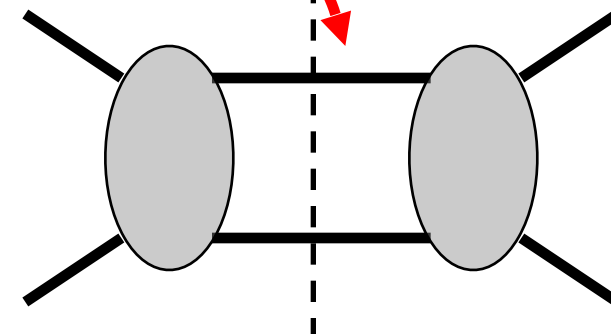


# Basic Tool: Generalized Unitarity Method

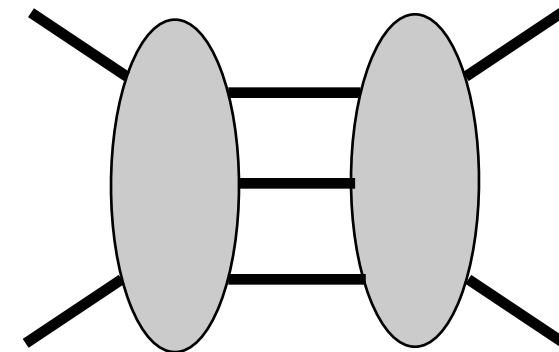
No Feynman rules; no need for virtual particles.

$$E^2 = \vec{p}^2 + m^2 \leftarrow \text{on-shell}$$

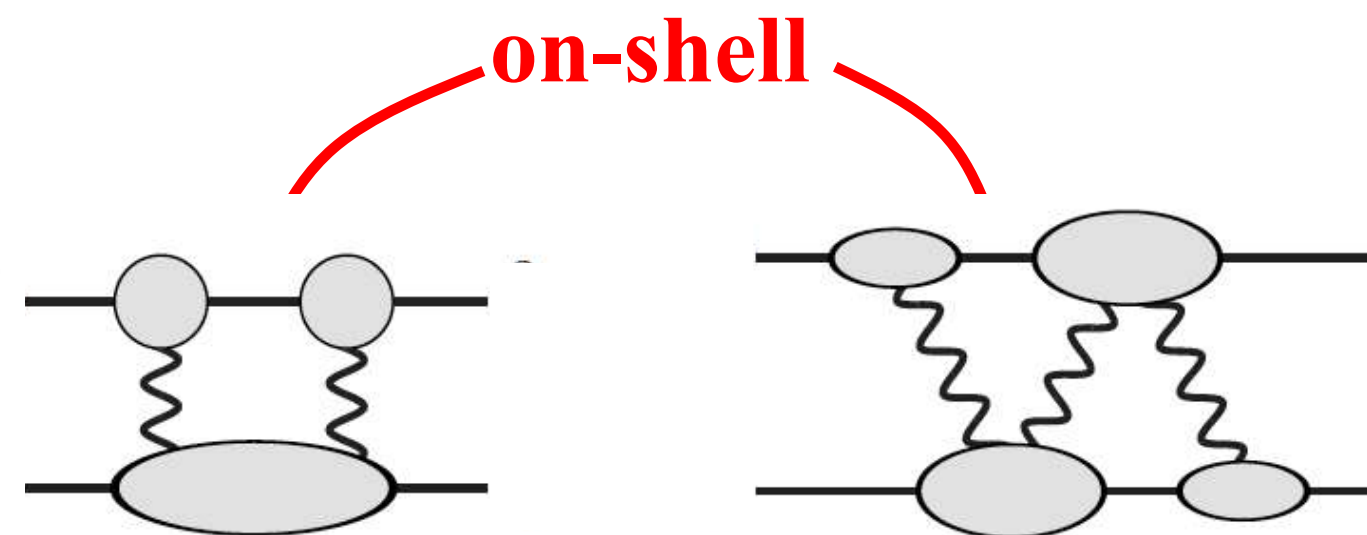
Two-particle cut:



Three-particle cut:



Generalized unitarity as a practical tool for loops.



ZB, Dixon, Dunbar and Kosower (1994)

- Systematic assembly of complete loop amplitudes from tree amplitudes.
- Works for any number of particles or loops.

ZB, Dixon and Kosower;  
ZB, Morgan;  
Britto, Cachazo, Feng;  
Ossala, Pittau, Papadopoulos;  
Ellis, Kunszt, Melnikov;  
Forde; Badger;  
ZB, Carrasco, Johansson, Kosower  
and many others

Designed to match results one would obtain from Feynman diagrams.  
Idea used in the “NLO revolution” in QCD collider physics.  
Here will discuss applications to gravity.



# Gauge Theory vs Gravity

Consider the Einstein gravity Lagrangian

$$L_{\text{gravity}} = \frac{2}{\kappa^2} \sqrt{-g} R$$

$\kappa^2 = 32\pi G_{\text{Newton}}$

curvature

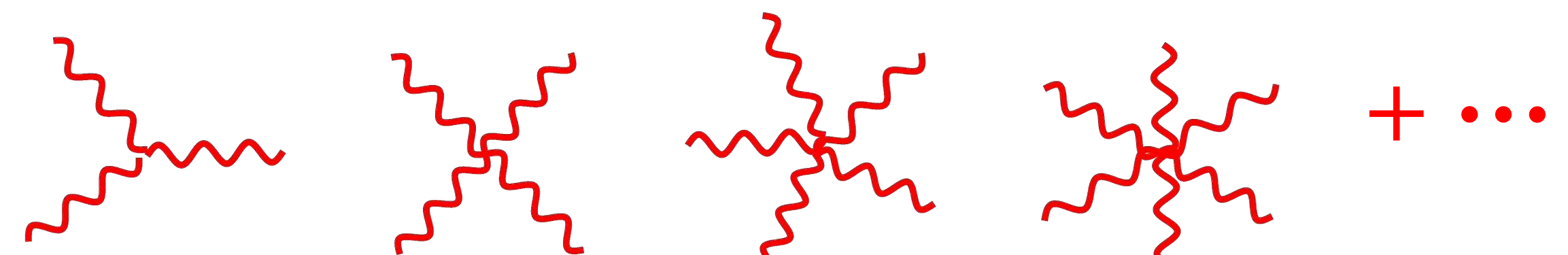
metric

Flat-space metric

graviton field

Infinite number of complicated interactions

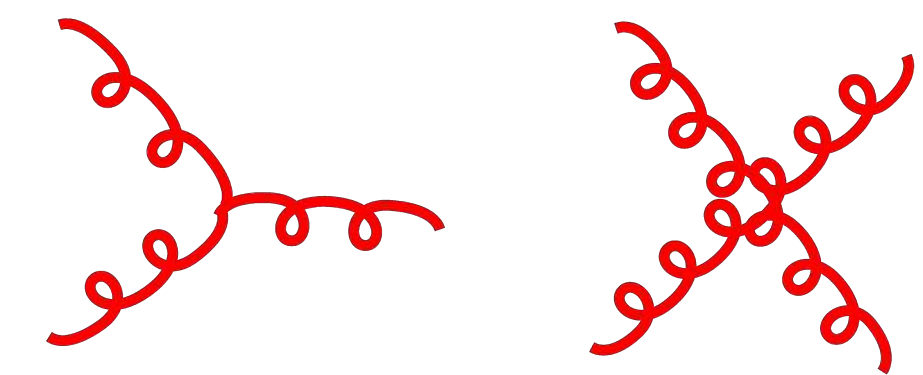
Very nonlinear



Compare to gauge-theory Lagrangian on which QCD is based

$$L_{\text{YM}} = \frac{1}{g^2} F^2$$

Only three and four point interactions



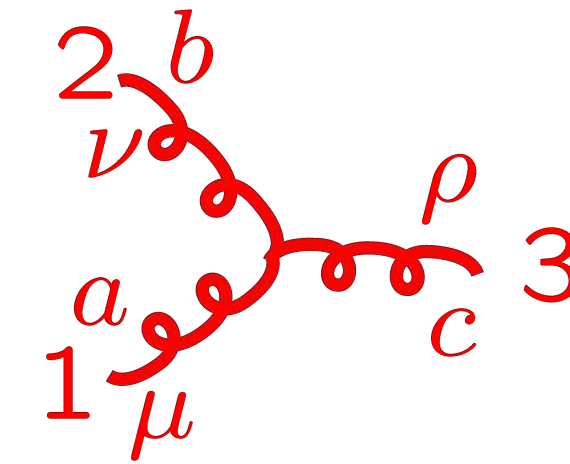
**Gravity seems so much more complicated than gauge theory.**



# Three-Point Interactions

Standard perturbative approach:

Three-gluon vertex from QCD strong interactions:



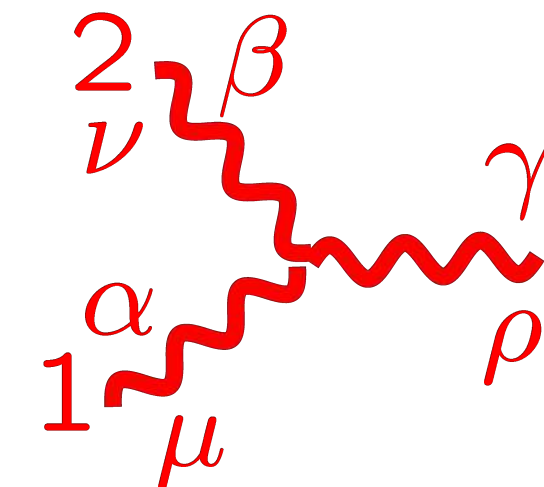
$$V_{3\mu\nu\sigma}^{abc} = -gf^{abc}(\eta_{\mu\nu}(k_1 - k_2)_\rho + \eta_{\nu\rho}(k_1 - k_2)_\mu + \eta_{\rho\mu}(k_1 - k_2)_\nu)$$

Three-graviton vertex:

$$k_i^2 = E_i^2 - \vec{k}_i^2 \neq 0$$

$$G_{3\mu\alpha,\nu\beta,\sigma\gamma}(k_1, k_2, k_3) =$$

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{sym} \left[ -\frac{1}{2}P_3(k_1 \cdot k_2 \eta_{\mu\alpha} \eta_{\nu\beta} \eta_{\sigma\gamma}) - \frac{1}{2}P_6(k_{1\nu} k_{1\beta} \eta_{\mu\alpha} \eta_{\sigma\gamma}) + \frac{1}{2}P_3(k_1 \cdot k_2 \eta_{\mu\nu} \eta_{\alpha\beta} \eta_{\sigma\gamma}) \right. \\ & + P_6(k_1 \cdot k_2 \eta_{\mu\alpha} \eta_{\nu\sigma} \eta_{\beta\gamma}) + 2P_3(k_{1\nu} k_{1\gamma} \eta_{\mu\alpha} \eta_{\beta\sigma}) - P_3(k_{1\beta} k_{2\mu} \eta_{\alpha\nu} \eta_{\sigma\gamma}) \\ & + P_3(k_{1\sigma} k_{2\gamma} \eta_{\mu\nu} \eta_{\alpha\beta}) + P_6(k_{1\sigma} k_{1\gamma} \eta_{\mu\nu} \eta_{\alpha\beta}) + 2P_6(k_{1\nu} k_{2\gamma} \eta_{\beta\mu} \eta_{\alpha\sigma}) \\ & \left. + 2P_3(k_{1\nu} k_{2\mu} \eta_{\beta\sigma} \eta_{\gamma\alpha}) - 2P_3(k_1 \cdot k_2 \eta_{\alpha\nu} \eta_{\beta\sigma} \eta_{\gamma\mu}) \right] \end{aligned}$$



About 100 terms in three vertex

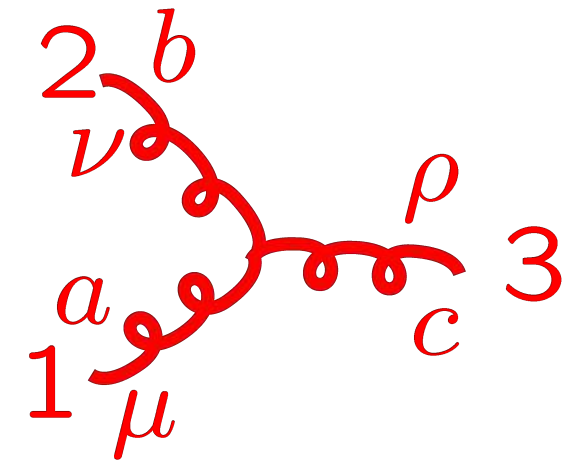
Naïve conclusion: Perturbative gravity is a mess.

# Simplicity of Gravity Amplitudes

People were looking at gravity amplitudes the wrong way.  
On-shell viewpoint more powerful.

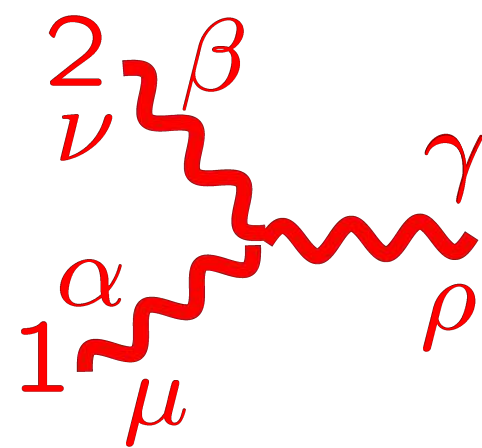
*On-shell* three vertices contains all information:  $E_i^2 - \vec{k}_i^2 = 0$

**Yang-Mills  
gauge theory,  
QCD:**



$$-g f^{abc} (\eta_{\mu\nu} (k_1 - k_2)_\rho + \text{cyclic})$$

**Einstein  
gravity:**



$$i\kappa (\eta_{\mu\nu} (k_1 - k_2)_\rho + \text{cyclic}) \\ \times (\eta_{\alpha\beta} (k_1 - k_2)_\gamma + \text{cyclic})$$

“square” of Yang-  
Mills vertex.

Simple interactions dictated by gravitons being massless spin 2 particles.

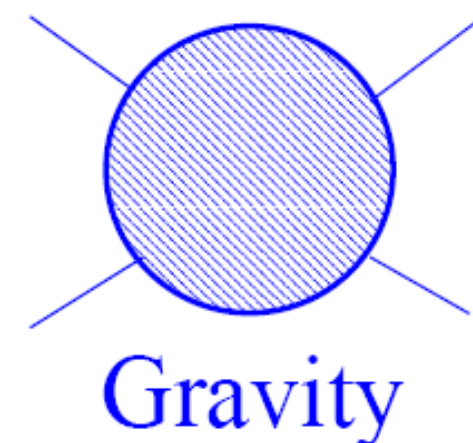


# KLT Relation Between Gravity and Gauge Theory

KLT (1985)

Kawai-Lewellen-Tye string relations in low-energy limit:

$$\begin{aligned} M_4^{\text{tree}}(1, 2, 3, 4) &= -is_{12} A_4^{\text{tree}}(1, 2, 3, 4) A_4^{\text{tree}}(1, 2, 4, 3), \\ M_5^{\text{tree}}(1, 2, 3, 4, 5) &= is_{12}s_{34} A_5^{\text{tree}}(1, 2, 3, 4, 5) A_5^{\text{tree}}(2, 1, 4, 3, 5) \\ &\quad + is_{13}s_{24} A_5^{\text{tree}}(1, 3, 2, 4, 5) A_5^{\text{tree}}(3, 1, 4, 2, 5) \end{aligned}$$



~



×



Generalizes to explicit all-leg form.

ZB, Dixon, Perelstein, Rozowsky

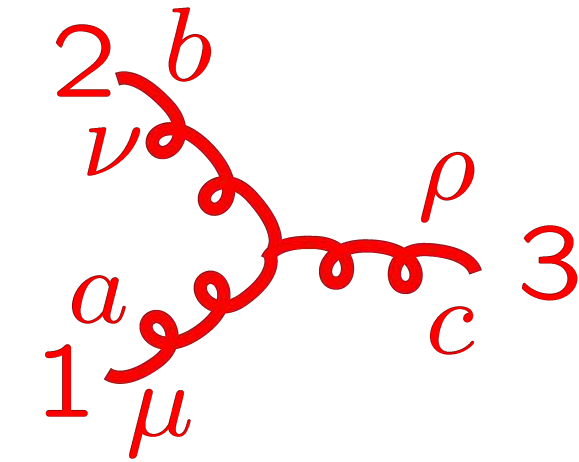
1. Gravity is derivable from gauge theory. Standard Lagrangian methods offers no hint why this is possible.
2. It is very generally applicable.

# Duality Between Color and Kinematics

ZB, Carrasco, Johansson (BCJ)

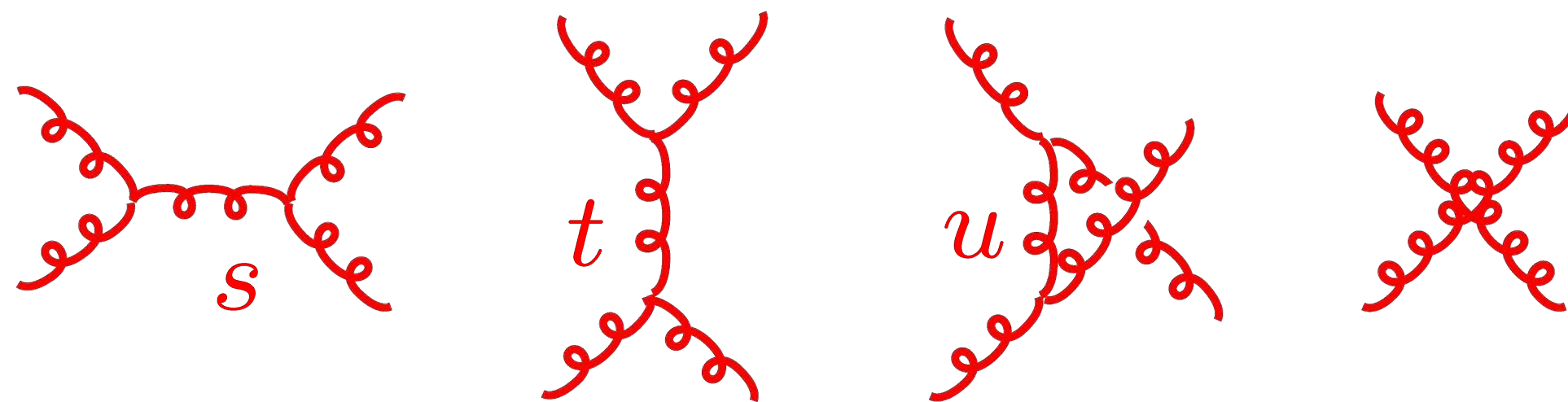
coupling constant  $\rightarrow$  color factor  $\rightarrow$  momentum dependent kinematic factor

$$-g f^{abc} (\eta_{\mu\nu} (k_1 - k_2)_\rho + \text{cyclic})$$



Color factors based on a Lie algebra:  $[T^a, T^b] = i f^{abc} T^c$

**Jacobi Identity**  $f^{a_1 a_2 b} f^{b a_4 a_3} + f^{a_4 a_2 b} f^{b a_3 a_1} + f^{a_4 a_1 b} f^{b a_2 a_3} = 0$



Use  $1 = s/s = t/t = u/u$   
to assign 4-point diagram  
to others.

$$\mathcal{A}_4^{\text{tree}} = g^2 \left( \frac{n_s c_s}{s} + \frac{n_t c_t}{t} + \frac{n_u c_u}{u} \right)$$

$$s = (k_1 + k_2)^2 \quad t = (k_1 + k_4)^2$$

$$u = (k_1 + k_3)^2$$

Color factors satisfy Jacobi identity:  
Numerator factors satisfy similar identity:

$$c_u = c_s - c_t$$

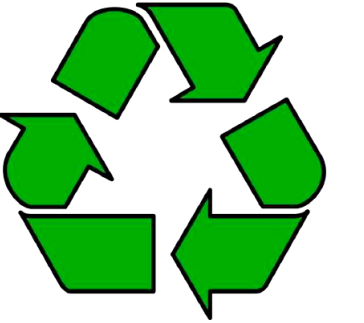
$$n_u = n_s - n_t$$

The secret of perturbative gravity is found here.



# Gravity as a Double Copy of Gauge Theory

ZB, Carrasco, Johansson



**gauge theory  
(QCD):**

$$\mathcal{A}_n^{\text{tree}} = ig^{n-2} \sum_i \frac{c_i n_i}{D_i}$$

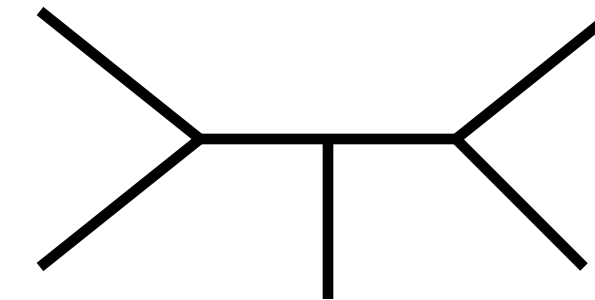
color factor  
kinematic numerator factor  
Feynman propagators

Jacobi identities

$$c_k = c_i - c_j$$

$$n_k = n_i - n_j$$

$c_i \rightarrow n_i$



**sum over diagrams  
with only 3 vertices**

**Einstein gravity:**

$$\mathcal{M}_n^{\text{tree}} = i\kappa^{n-2} \sum_i \frac{n_i^2}{D_i}$$

$$n_i \sim k_4 \cdot k_5 k_2 \cdot \varepsilon_1 \varepsilon_2 \cdot \varepsilon_3 \varepsilon_4 \cdot \varepsilon_5 + \dots$$

**Gravity and gauge theory kinematic numerators are the same!**

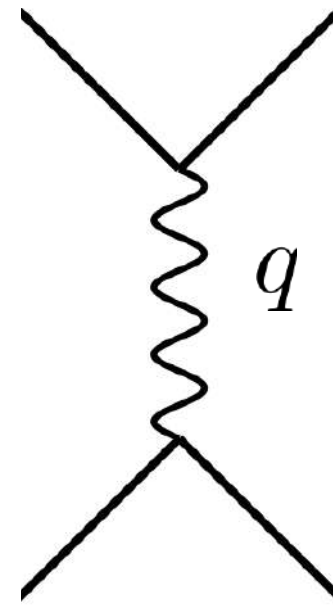
**Cries out for a unified description of gravity with gauge theory, presumably along the lines of string theory.**

# 2 Body Potentials and Amplitudes

**Tree-level: Fourier transform gives classical potential.**

$$V(r) \sim \int \frac{d^3 q}{(2\pi)^3} e^{-i\mathbf{q}\cdot\mathbf{r}} A^{\text{tree}}(\mathbf{q})$$

$$H(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{r}) = \sqrt{\mathbf{p}^2 + m_1^2} + \sqrt{\mathbf{p}^2 + m_2^2} + V(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{r})$$



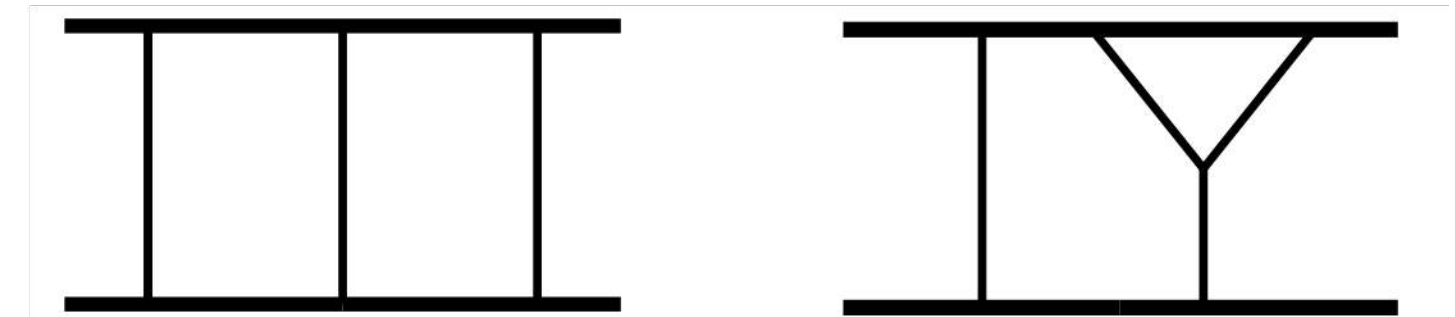
**Newtonian potential follows  
follows from tree amplitude**

$$V(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{r}) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} c_i(\mathbf{p}^2) \left( \frac{G_N}{|\mathbf{r}|} \right)^i$$

**Beyond 1 loop more complicated:**

- **Loops have classical pieces.**
- **$1/\hbar^L$  scaling at  $L$  loop.**
- **Double counting and iteration.**

$$e^{iS_{\text{classical}}/\hbar}$$



**Piece of loops are classical: Our task is to efficiently extract these pieces.  
Also radiative and dissipative effects are contained in the amplitude.**



# General Relativity: Unitarity + Double Copy

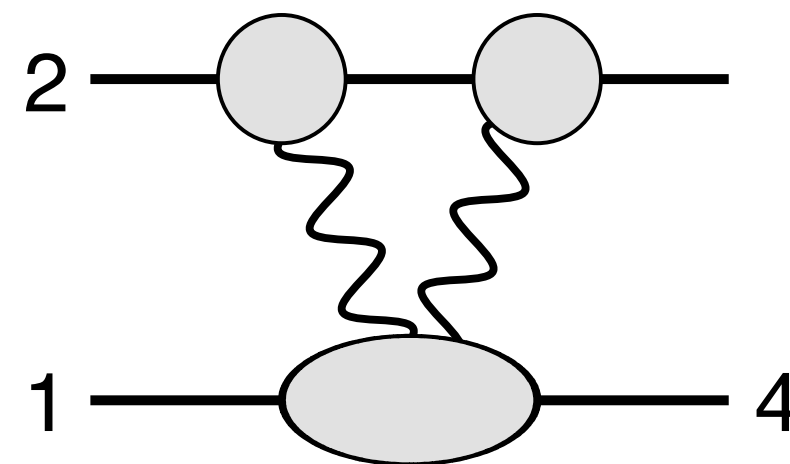
- Long-range force: Two matter lines separated by graviton propagators.
- Classical physics: 1 matter line per loop is cut (on-shell).

$$E^2 = \vec{p}^2 + m^2$$

**Only independent unitarity cut for  $O(G^2)$ .**

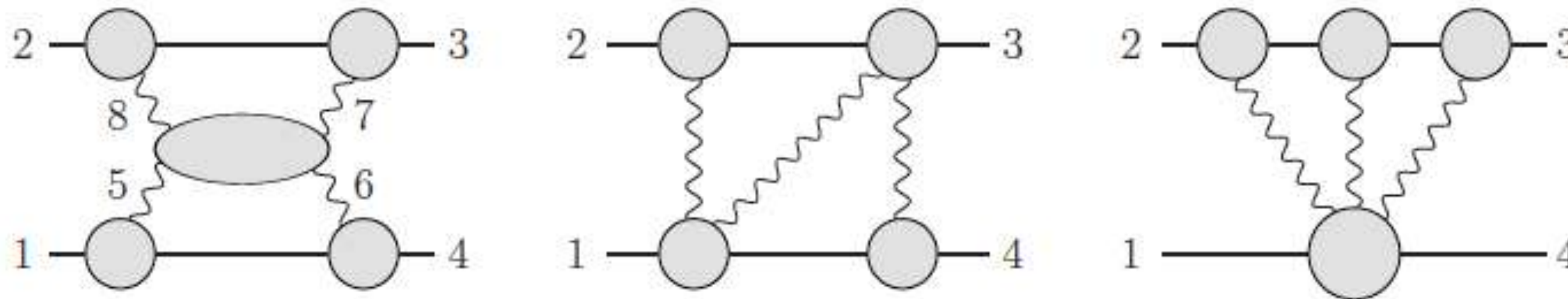
**G is Newton's constant**

**2 black hole scattering**



**Treat exposed lines on-shell (long range).  
Pieces we want are simple!**

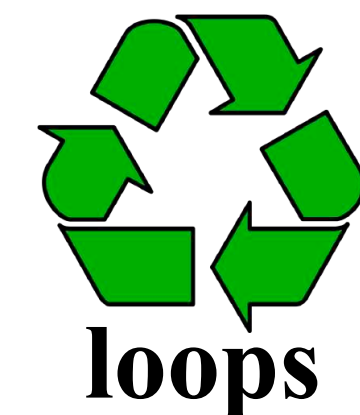
**Independent generalized unitarity cuts for  $O(G^3)$ .**



**Amplitude tools fit well for  
extracting the pieces we want.**



**gravity**



**loops**

# Improved Methods for Extracting Classical Physics.

There are now multiple alternative ways to extract classical physics.

- **EFT matching to 2 body Hamiltonian** Cheng, Solon, Rothstein;  
ZB, Cheung, Roiban, Shen, Zeng
- **Map to EOB** Bini, Damour, Geralico
- **Calculate physical observables** Kosower, Maybee, O'Connell (KMOC)
- **Eikonal phase** Amati, Ciafaloni, Veneziano;  
Di Vecchia, Heissenberg, Russo, Veneziano
- **Amplitude radial-action relation** ZB, Parra-Martinez, Roiban, Ruf,  
Shen, Solon, Zeng
- **Exponential representation** Damgaard, Plante, Vanhove;  
Bjerrum-Bohr, Plante, Vanhove
- **Heavy mass field theory** Brandhuber, Chen, Travaglini, Wen  
Damgaard, Haddad, Helset
- **Worldline formalisms** Goldberger, Rothstein; Levi, Steinhoff; Dlapa, Kälin, Liu, Porto;  
Jakobson, Mogul, Plefka, Steinhoff; Edison, Levi; etc
- **Magnusian approach** Kim, Patil, Sheopner, Steinhoff; Guo, J. Kim, J. Kim, S. Kim, Lee, Li;  
Gonzo, Mogull

**These days, radial action and KMOC are our preferred methods.**



# Amplitude in Conservative Classical Potential Limit

ZB, Cheung, Roiban, Shen, Solon, Zeng (2019)

First paper beyond 2PM: The  $O(G^3)$  or 3PM conservative terms are:

$$\mathcal{M}_3 = \frac{\pi G^3 \nu^2 m^4 \log q^2}{6\gamma^2 \xi} \left[ 3 - 6\nu + 206\nu\sigma - 54\sigma^2 + 108\nu\sigma^2 + 4\nu\sigma^3 - \frac{48\nu(3 + 12\sigma^2 - 4\sigma^4) \operatorname{arcsinh} \sqrt{\frac{\sigma-1}{2}}}{\sqrt{\sigma^2-1}} - \frac{18\nu\gamma(1-2\sigma^2)(1-5\sigma^2)}{(1+\gamma)(1+\sigma)} \right] + \frac{8\pi^3 G^3 \nu^4 m^6}{\gamma^4 \xi} \left[ 3\gamma(1-2\sigma^2)(1-5\sigma^2)F_1 - 32m^2\nu^2(1-2\sigma^2)^3 F_2 \right]$$

$$m = m_A + m_B, \quad \mu = m_A m_B / m, \quad \nu = \mu / m, \quad \gamma = E / m,$$

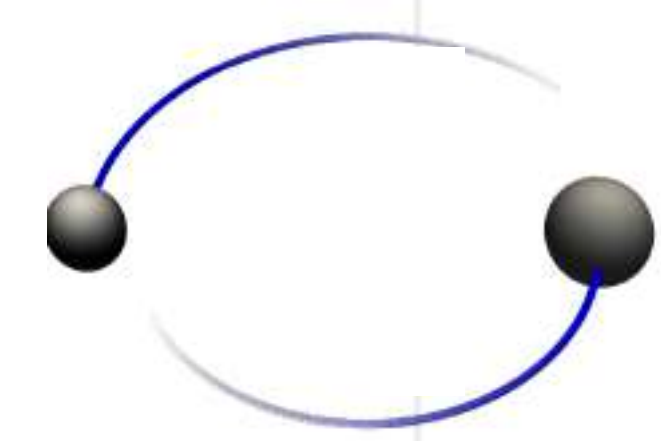
$$\xi = E_1 E_2 / E^2, \quad E = E_1 + E_2, \quad \sigma = p_1 \cdot p_2 / m_1 m_2,$$

- Amplitude remarkably compact.
- Arcsinh and the appearance of a mass singularity is new feature.  $\log(E^2/m_1 m_2)$   
Di Vecchia, Heissenberg, Russo, Veneziano; Damour
- Derived conservative scattering angle has simple mass dependence.

Antonelli, Buonanno, Steinhoff, van de Meent, Vines  
Comprehensive understanding: Damour

# Our First Paper: Conservative 3PM Hamiltonian

ZB, Cheung, Roiban, Shen, Solon, Zeng (2019)



The 3PM two body Hamiltonian:

$$H(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{r}) = \sqrt{\mathbf{p}^2 + m_1^2} + \sqrt{\mathbf{p}^2 + m_2^2} + V(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{r})$$

$$V(\mathbf{p}, \mathbf{r}) = \sum_{i=1}^3 c_i(\mathbf{p}^2) \left( \frac{G}{|\mathbf{r}|} \right)^i,$$

Newton in here

$$c_1 = \frac{\nu^2 m^2}{\gamma^2 \xi} (1 - 2\sigma^2), \quad c_2 = \frac{\nu^2 m^3}{\gamma^2 \xi} \left[ \frac{3}{4} (1 - 5\sigma^2) - \frac{4\nu\sigma (1 - 2\sigma^2)}{\gamma\xi} - \frac{\nu^2 (1 - \xi) (1 - 2\sigma^2)^2}{2\gamma^3 \xi^2} \right],$$

$$c_3 = \frac{\nu^2 m^4}{\gamma^2 \xi} \left[ \frac{1}{12} (3 - 6\nu + 206\nu\sigma - 54\sigma^2 + 108\nu\sigma^2 + 4\nu\sigma^3) - \frac{4\nu (3 + 12\sigma^2 - 4\sigma^4) \operatorname{arcsinh} \sqrt{\frac{\sigma-1}{2}}}{\sqrt{\sigma^2 - 1}} \right. \\ \left. - \frac{3\nu\gamma (1 - 2\sigma^2) (1 - 5\sigma^2)}{2(1 + \gamma)(1 + \sigma)} - \frac{3\nu\sigma (7 - 20\sigma^2)}{2\gamma\xi} - \frac{\nu^2 (3 + 8\gamma - 3\xi - 15\sigma^2 - 80\gamma\sigma^2 + 15\xi\sigma^2) (1 - 2\sigma^2)}{4\gamma^3 \xi^2} \right. \\ \left. + \frac{2\nu^3 (3 - 4\xi)\sigma (1 - 2\sigma^2)^2}{\gamma^4 \xi^3} + \frac{\nu^4 (1 - 2\xi) (1 - 2\sigma^2)^3}{2\gamma^6 \xi^4} \right],$$

$$m = m_A + m_B, \quad \mu = m_A m_B / m, \quad \nu = \mu / m, \quad \gamma = E / m, \\ \xi = E_1 E_2 / E^2, \quad E = E_1 + E_2, \quad \sigma = \mathbf{p}_1 \cdot \mathbf{p}_2 / m_1 m_2,$$

Scattering amplitude methods are useful for gravitational-wave problem



# How do we know it is right?

## Original checks:

- Compared to 4PN Hamiltonians (after canonical transformation)
- In test mass limit,  $m_1 \ll m_2$ , matches Schwarzschild Hamiltonian

Damour, Jaranowski, Schäfer; Bernard, Blanchet, Bohé, Faye, Marsat

**Results met with initial skepticism.** Damour, arXiv:1912.02139v1

## Subsequent calculations confirm our 3PM result:

1. Subsequent papers confirm our result in 6PN overlap after initial skepticism.

Blümlein, Maier, Marquard, Schäfer; Bini, Damour, Geralico

2. New calculations reproducing 3PM result.

Cheung and Solon; Kälin, Liu, Porto;

3. Adding (non-conservative) real radiation clarifies a puzzle at high energies.

Di Vecchia, Heissenberg, Russo, Veneziano; Damour

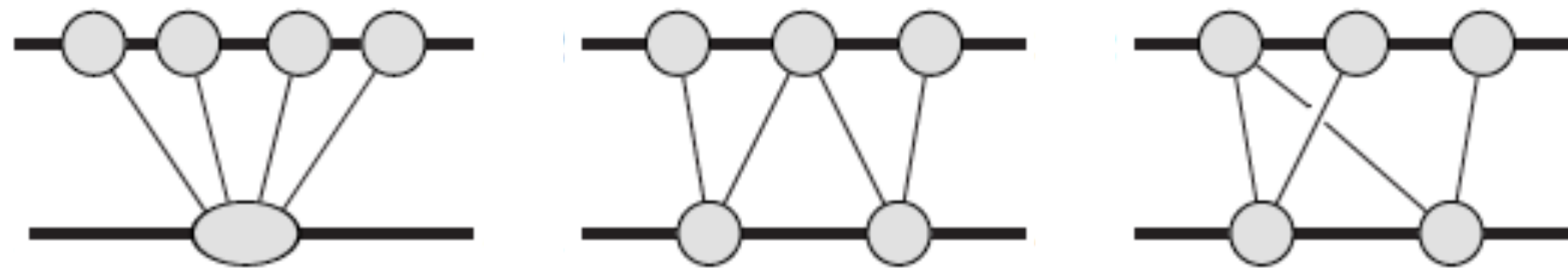
**3PM results have passed highly nontrivial checks and careful scrutiny.**

# Higher Orders: $O(G^4)$ & $O(G^5)$

Methods scale well to higher orders

ZB, Parra-Martinez, Roiban, Ruf,  
Shen, Solon, Zeng (2022)

$O(G^4)$

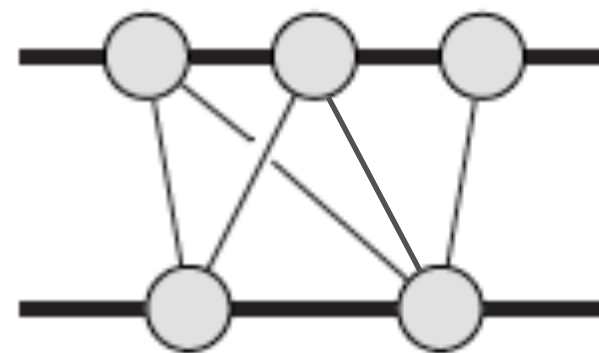


etc

**$O(G^4)$  done,  
but nontrivial time nonlocality  
issues not completely resolved.**

Dissipative effects: Manohar, Shen and Ridgeway; Dlapa, Kalen, Lui, Neef, Porto; Damgaard, Hansen, Planté, Vanhove.

$O(G^5)$



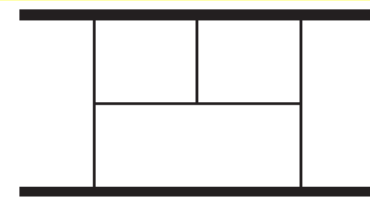
**Good progress. Integrals are the main issue.**

ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng.  
Klemm, Naga, Sauer, Plefka; Driesse, Jakobson, Mogull, Plefka,  
Sauer, Usovitch.

**Goal is  $O(G^6)$ : Need factor 100 precision increase. Highly Nontrivial!**



# Complete Conservative Contribution $O(G^4)$



test particle

1<sup>st</sup> self force

Iteration. No need to compute

ZB, Parra-Martinez, Roiban, Ruf, Shen, Solon, Zeng

$O(G^4)$  amplitude

$$\mathcal{M}_4^{\text{cons}} = G^4 M^7 \nu^2 |q| \pi^2 \left[ \mathcal{M}_4^{\text{p}} + \nu \left( 4\mathcal{M}_4^{\text{t}} \log\left(\frac{p_\infty}{2}\right) + \mathcal{M}_4^{\pi^2} + \mathcal{M}_4^{\text{rem}} \right) \right] + \underbrace{\int_{\ell} \frac{\tilde{I}_{r,1}^4}{Z_1 Z_2 Z_3} + \int_{\ell} \frac{\tilde{I}_{r,1}^2 \tilde{I}_{r,2}}{Z_1 Z_2} + \int_{\ell} \frac{\tilde{I}_{r,1} \tilde{I}_{r,3}}{Z_1} + \int_{\ell} \frac{\tilde{I}_{r,2}^2}{Z_1}}_{\text{tail effect}}$$

$$D = 4 - 2\epsilon$$

$$\mathcal{M}_4^{\text{t}} = r_1 + r_2 \log\left(\frac{\sigma+1}{2}\right) + r_3 \frac{\text{arccosh}(\sigma)}{\sqrt{\sigma^2-1}}, \quad \mathcal{M}_4^{\text{p}} = -\frac{35(1-18\sigma^2+33\sigma^4)}{8(\sigma^2-1)}$$

$$\mathcal{M}_4^{\pi^2} = r_4 \pi^2 + r_5 K\left(\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma+1}\right) E\left(\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma+1}\right) + r_6 K^2\left(\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma+1}\right) + r_7 E^2\left(\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma+1}\right), \quad \leftarrow \text{elliptic integrals}$$

$$\mathcal{M}_4^{\text{rem}} = r_8 + r_9 \log\left(\frac{\sigma+1}{2}\right) + r_{10} \frac{\text{arccosh}(\sigma)}{\sqrt{\sigma^2-1}} + r_{11} \log(\sigma) + r_{12} \log^2\left(\frac{\sigma+1}{2}\right) + r_{13} \frac{\text{arccosh}(\sigma)}{\sqrt{\sigma^2-1}} \log\left(\frac{\sigma+1}{2}\right) + r_{14} \frac{\text{arccosh}^2(\sigma)}{\sigma^2-1} \\ + r_{15} \text{Li}_2\left(\frac{1-\sigma}{2}\right) + r_{16} \text{Li}_2\left(\frac{1-\sigma}{1+\sigma}\right) + r_{17} \frac{1}{\sqrt{\sigma^2-1}} \left[ \text{Li}_2\left(-\sqrt{\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma+1}}\right) - \text{Li}_2\left(\sqrt{\frac{\sigma-1}{\sigma+1}}\right) \right].$$

$$\nu = m_1 m_2 / (m_1 + m_2)^2$$

$$\sigma = p_1 \cdot p_2 / m_1 m_2,$$

$r_i$  rational coefficients

**This is *complete* conservative contribution.**

$$\mathcal{M}_4^{\text{radgrav,f}} = \frac{12044}{75} p_\infty^2 + \frac{212077}{3675} p_\infty^4 + \frac{115917979}{793800} p_\infty^6 - \frac{9823091209}{76839840} p_\infty^8 + \frac{115240251793703}{1038874636800} p_\infty^{10} + \dots$$

**First 3 terms match 6PN results of Bini, Damour, Geralico!**

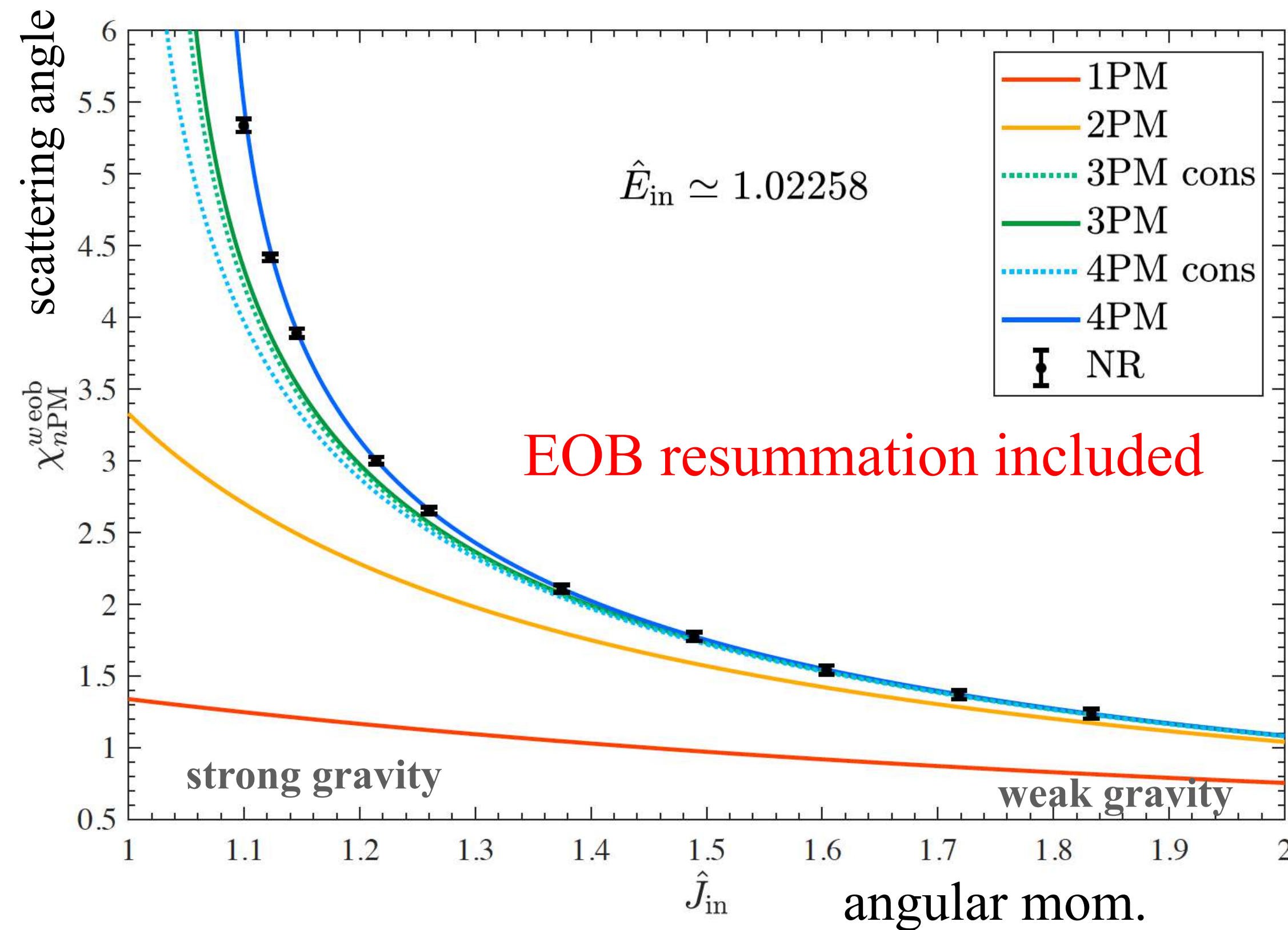
**Nontrivial analytic continuation of certain time nonlocal terms.**

**Partial patch.**

Khalil, Buonanno, Steinhoff, Vines; Dlapa, Kalin, Liu, Porto; Damour, Retegno

# Comparison with Numerical Relativity in Overlap Region

Khalil, Buonanno, Vines, Steinhoff; Damour and Retegno



Plots use:

4PM Conservative: ZB, Parra-Martinez, Roiban, Ruf, Shen, Solon, Zeng

4PM Dissipative: Manohar, Shen and Ridgeway; Dlapa, Kalen, Lui, Neef, Porto

NR: Damour, Guercilena, Hinder, Hopper, Nagar, Rezzolla

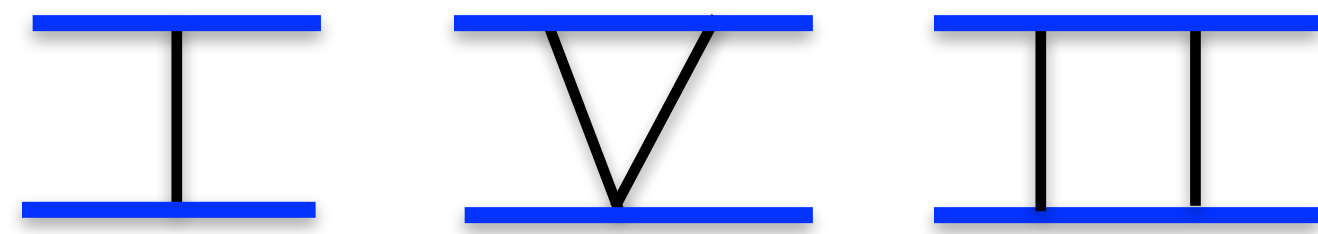
- Strikingly good agreement with numerical relativity.
- Shows we are on a good track!



# New Challenges and Theoretical Issues at Each Order

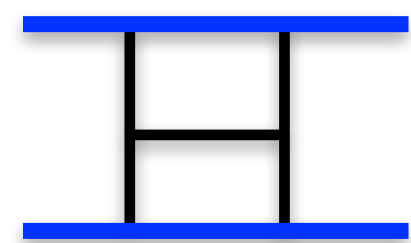
Moving up in orders of PM new effects and features encountered:

**1PM and 2PM:** Fixed by geodesic motion, 0SF.



$$ds^2 = - \left( 1 - \frac{2M}{r} \right) dt^2 + \frac{1}{1 - \frac{2M}{r}} dr^2 + r^2 d\theta^2 + r^2 \sin^2(\theta) d\phi^2$$

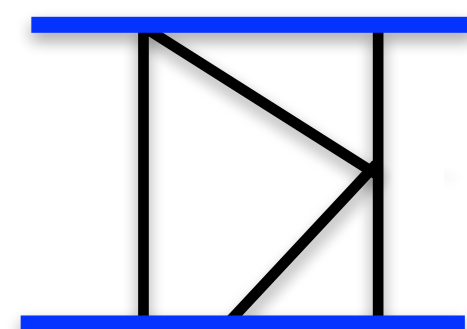
**3PM:** Interesting structure in high energy limit. 1SF,  $m_1/m_2$ , beyond geodesic motion



$$\log(E^2/m_1 m_2)$$

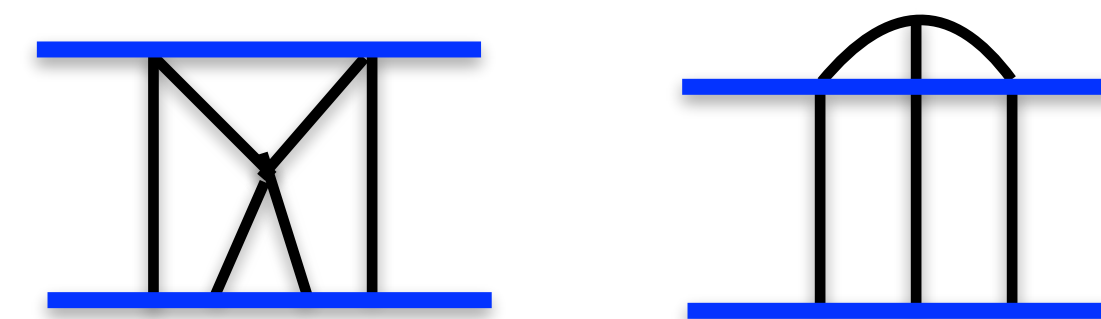
Cancels against real radiation

**4PM:** Tail effect, nontrivial analytic continuations, elliptic integrals, *noncancellation* of poor high-energy behavior. Nonlocal in time “tail” effect.

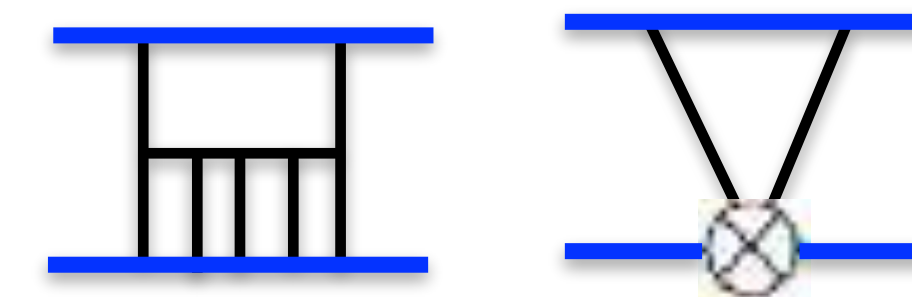


$$\sim K^2 \left( \frac{\sigma - 1}{\sigma + 1} \right)$$

**5PM:** 2SF, new nontrivial functions.

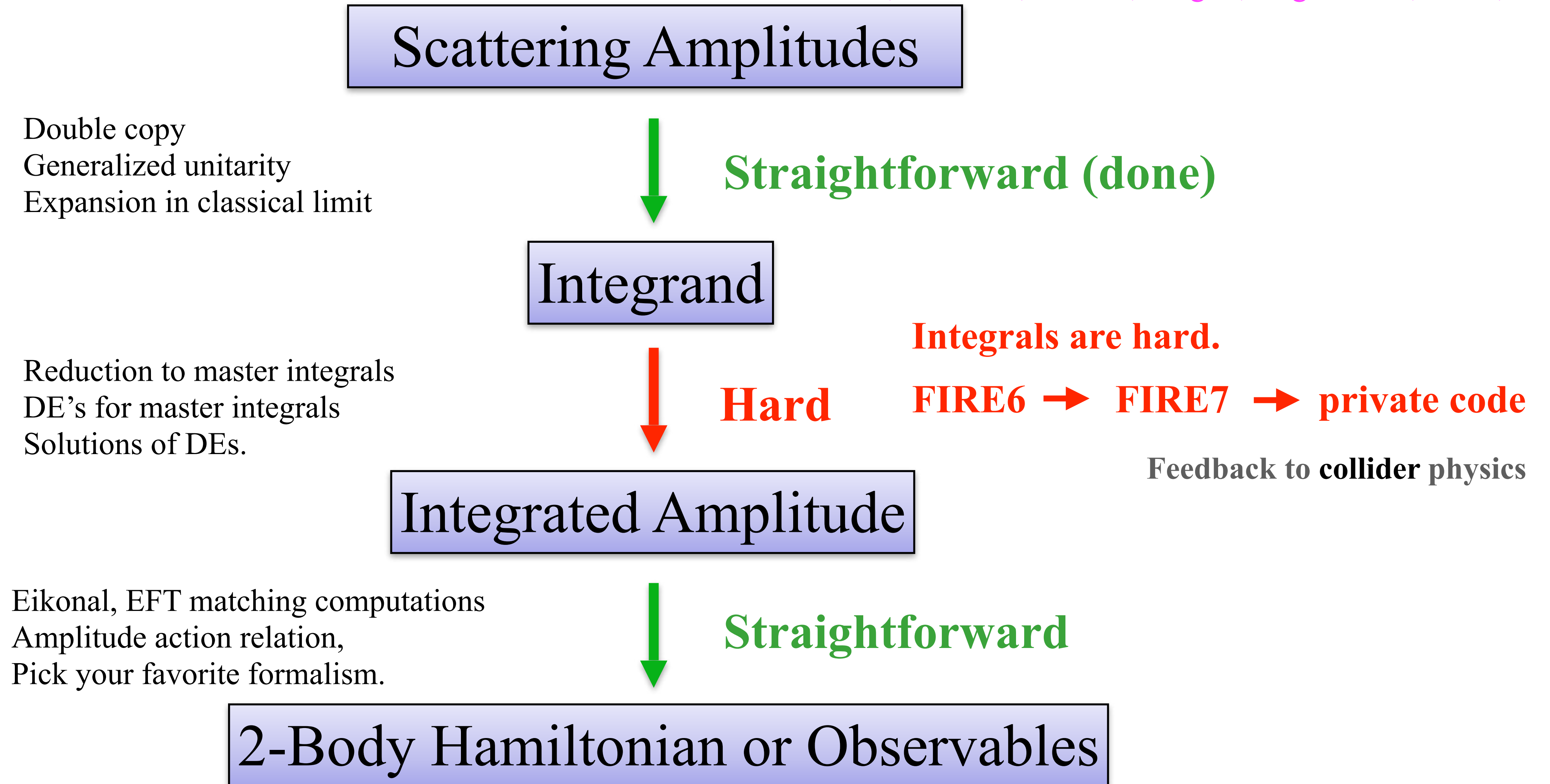


**6PM:** Mixing with tidal operators, UV divergences.  
Distinguish BHs from neutron stars.  
Renormalization in classical physics.



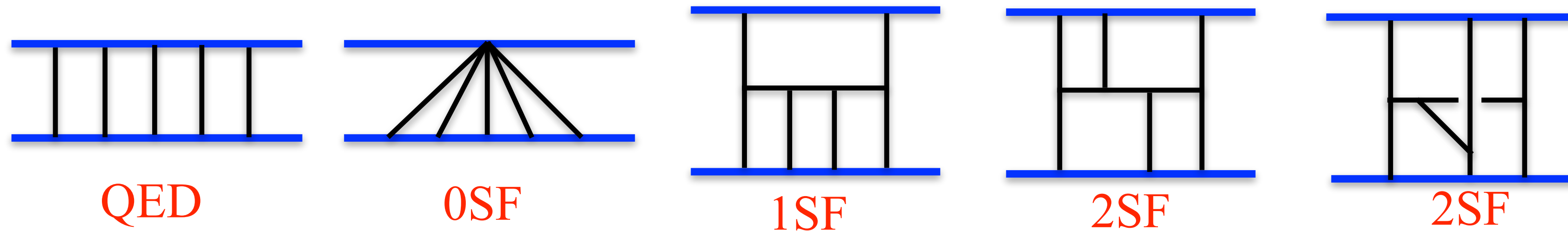
# Towards 5PM, $O(G^5)$

ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov; Zeng;  
Driesse, Jakobsen, Klemm, Mogull, Nega Plefka, Sauer, Usovitsch





# Deal With 5PM Integration in Stages



## Stages:

- 1. QED warmup. Potential mode contributions.** **Done.**  
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng
- 2. 1SF Conservative + Dissipative** **Done.**  
Driesse, Jakobsen, Mogull, Plefka, Sauer, Usovitch
- 3.  $N = 8$  sugra (lower tensor rank)** **Both 1SF and 2SF potential done.**  
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng
- 4. GR 2SF “Conservative”.** **Done**  
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smith, Zeng;  
Driesse, Jakobsen, Mogul, Nega, Plefka, Sauer, Usovitch
- 5. Dissipative effects.** **To be done**

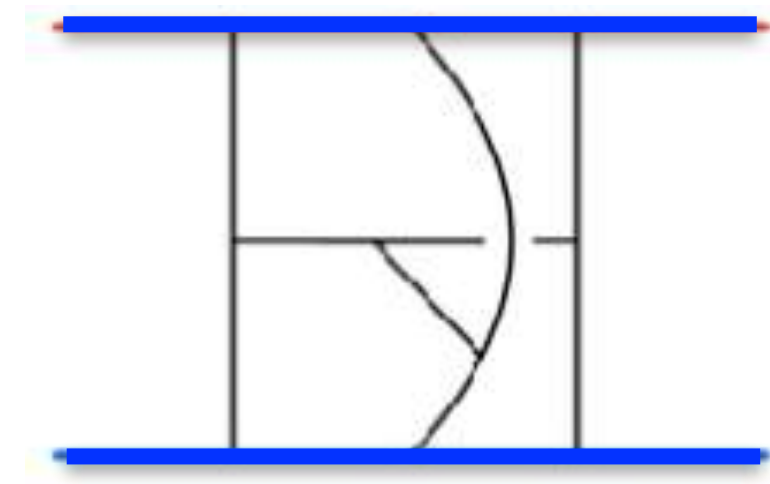
$$M_{5\text{PM}} = M_{5\text{PM}}^{0\text{SF}} + \nu M_{5\text{PM}}^{1\text{SF}} + \nu^2 M_{\text{PM}}^{2\text{SF}} \quad \nu = \frac{m_1 m_2}{(m_1 + m_2)^2}$$

**Learn from each stage to push forward the next one.**

# Bottleneck: Integral Evaluation

Primary bottleneck is integrals:

22 indices: 13 propagator and 9 irreducible scalar products (ISPs)



$$\int \frac{d^4D k [u_2 \cdot k_1]^{a-14} [u_2 \cdot k_4]^{a-15} [u_1 \cdot k_2]^{a-16} [u_1 \cdot k_3]^{a-17} [k_1 \cdot q]^{a-18} [k_2 \cdot q]^{a-19} [k_1 \cdot k_2]^{a-20} [k_1 \cdot k_4]^{a-21} [k_2 \cdot k_3]^{a-22}}{[-2u_2 \cdot k_2]^{a_1} [-2u_2 \cdot k_{123}]^{a_2} [2u_1 \cdot k_{234}]^{a_3} [2u_1 \cdot k_{1234}]^{a_4} [k_1^2]^{a_5} [k_2^2]^{a_6} [k_3^2]^{a_7} [k_{13}^2]^{a_8} [k_4^2]^{a_9} [k_{34}^2]^{a_{10}} [k_{234}^2]^{a_{11}} [(k_{123} - q)^2]^{a_{12}} [(k_{1234} - q)^2]^{a_{13}}}$$

Very similar to wordliine integrals. KMOC version gives identical integrand as WLQFT

Capatti and Zeng

Encounter up to 8 numerator powers and 4 doubled propagators.

ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smith, Zeng;

Driesse, Jakobsen, Mogull, Plefka, Sauer, Usovitsch

The fundamental issue isn't the millions of integrals, it's the complexity.

No public code out of the box can deal with this.



# Basic Tool Is IBP

**In QCD/Amplitudes advanced technology for loop integrals which we import.**

**1. IBP greatly simplified in classical limit.**

Chetyrkin, Tkachov; Laporta; Henn; Henn and Smirnov  
Beneke and Smirnov; Parra-Martinez, Ruf, Zeng

**2. Choose master integrals carefully to simplify IBPs.**

A. Smirnov and V. Smirnov; Usovitsch

**3. Use finite prime fields and reconstruction for toughest IBPs.**

Manteuffel, Schabinger; Peraro

Kotikov, ZB, Dixon and Kosower; Gehrmann, Remiddi

**IBP:** 
$$0 = \int \prod_i^L \frac{d^D \ell_i}{(2\pi)^D} \frac{\partial}{\partial \ell_i^\mu} \frac{N^\mu(\ell_k, p_M)}{Z_1 \dots Z_n}$$

**Solve linear relations for master integrals,  
usually the simplest ones.**

**Our basic tools:**

**1. *Highly modified* private version of FIRE.**

Smirnov, Chuharev; Lee; Smirnov, Zeng

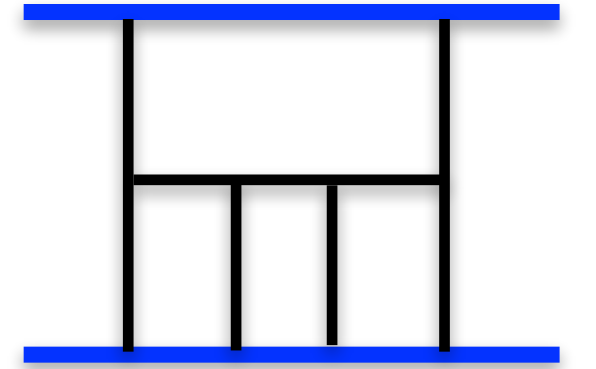
**2. Finite fields and reconstruction.**

Von Manteuffel and a Schabinger; Peraro

**KIRA has also be been upgraded.**

Maierhoefer, Usovitsch, Uwer;  
Klappert, Lange, Maierhöfer, Usovitsch

**All integrals reduced to “Master integrals”**



# Finite Field Methods and Supercomputers

**Question:** Given a large linear system (million unknowns) whose solution is rational functions over multiple variables, how to solve analytically?

**Answer:** Finite field reconstruction.

A. von Manteuffel and R. Schabinger; T. Peraro

- Problem reduced to numerical evaluation on a prime field.
- Rational coefficients of master integrals fully reconstructed.

**Trivially parallelizable.**

**Scale of the calculation requires supercomputers.**

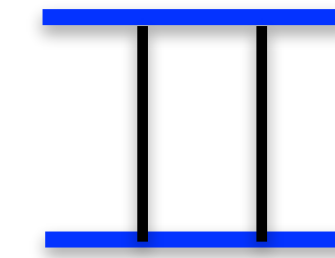
**Supercomputers critical but better algorithms even more critical**





# DEs for Master Integrals.

IBP can also be used to generate differential equations:



$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial}{\partial y} I[1,1,1,1] &= \frac{(u_2 - y u_1)}{1 - y^2} \cdot \frac{\partial}{\partial u_1} I[1,1,1,1] \\ &\stackrel{\text{Lorenz-invariance}}{=} \frac{y}{1 - y^2} I[1,1,1,1] + \frac{1}{1 - y^2} I[1,1,2,0] \\ &\stackrel{\text{IBP}}{=} \frac{y}{1 - y^2} I[1,1,1,1] + \frac{3 - d}{1 - y^2} I[1,1,0,0]\end{aligned}$$

$$y = u_1 \cdot u_2$$

The DEs can be solved either analytically or by series expansion.

# Structure of DEs

A 5 PM example of the DE matrix

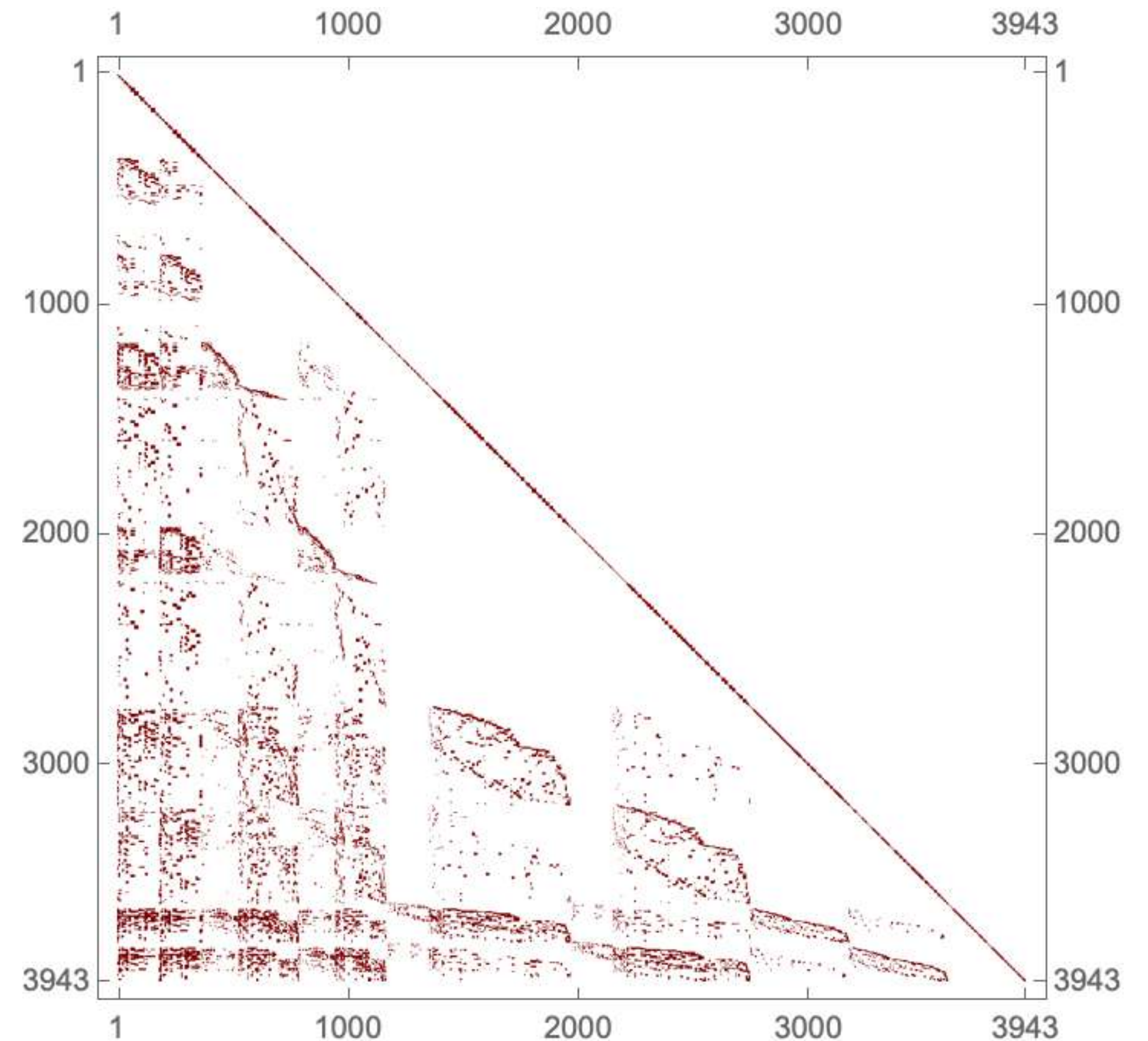
1st order coupled ODE

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial y} \begin{bmatrix} I_1 \\ \vdots \\ I_m \end{bmatrix} = M(y, \epsilon) \begin{bmatrix} I_1 \\ \vdots \\ I_m \end{bmatrix}$$

$m \times m$  matrix with rational entries

$$D = 4 - 2\epsilon$$

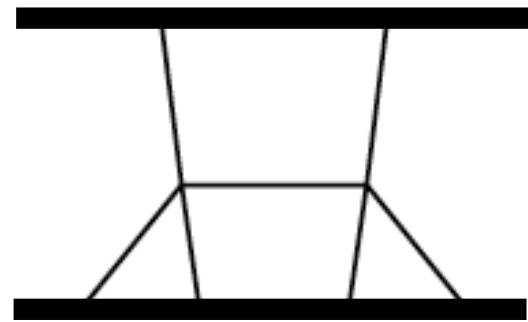
It takes considerable effort to clean up  $M$ .  
Want “canonical form”





# Nontrivial Special Functions

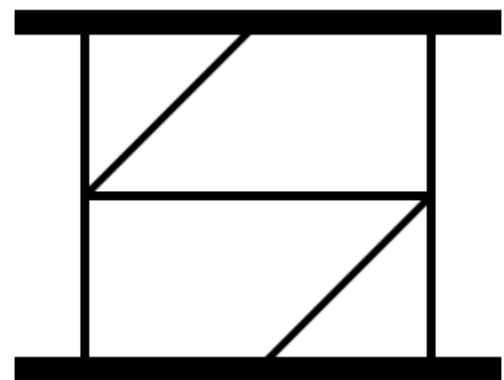
Elliptic, Heun and Calabi-Yau integrals appear.



At 1 SF, Elliptic integrals.

Driesse, Jakobsen, Klemm, Mogull, Nega Plefka, Sauer, Usovitsch  
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng.

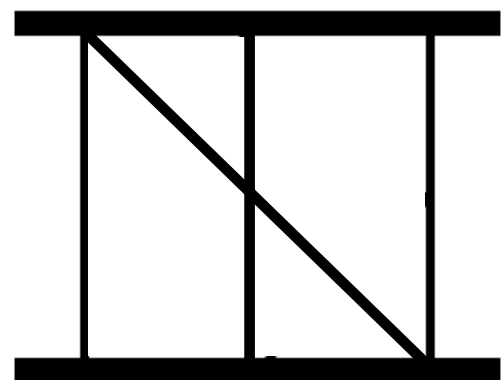
$$\Gamma_{i_1, \dots, i_n}(x) = \int_1^x dx_n k_{i_n}(x_n) \cdots \int_1^{x_2} dx_1 k_{i_1}(x_1)$$



At 2 SF, Calabi-Yau 3-fold integrals.

**Complicated IBP and DEs**

Frellesvig, Morales, Wilhelm; Klemm, Nega, Sauer, Plefka;  
Driesse, Jakobsen, Klemm, Mogul, Nega, Pelfka, Sauer, Usovitsch;  
Frellesvig, Morales, Pogel, Weinzierl, Wilhelm;  
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng;  
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smith, Zeng;

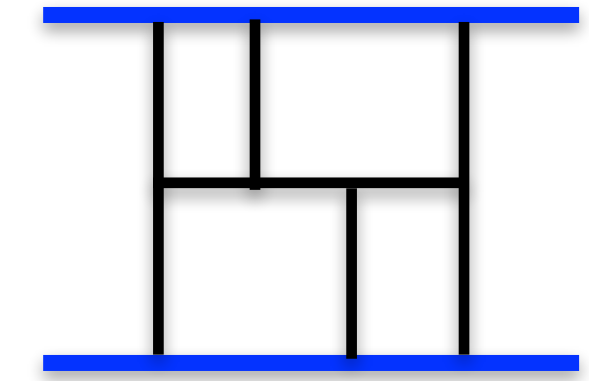


At 2 SF, Heun type integral.

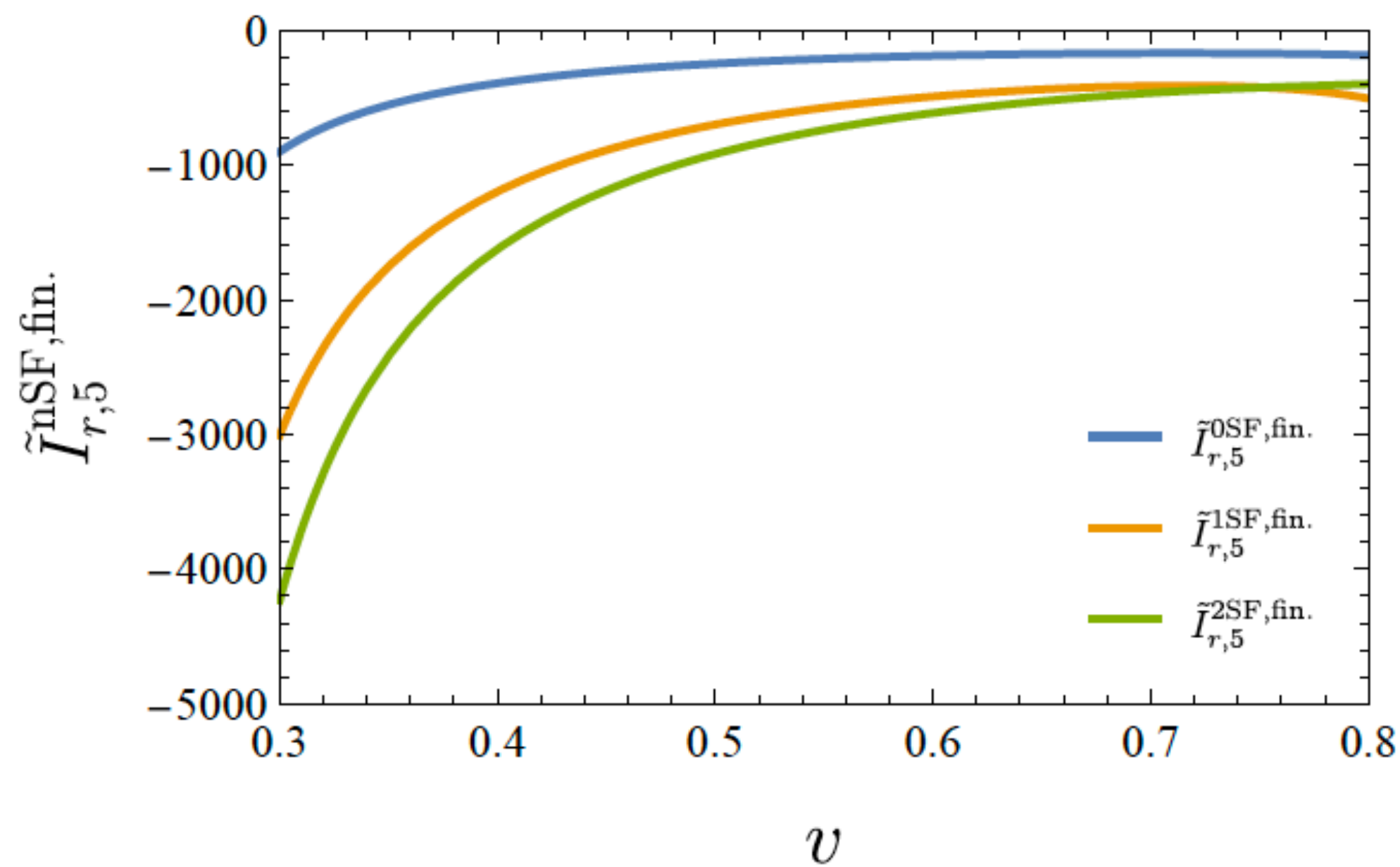
# 5PM GR Radial Action (Full 2SF Potential)

ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smith, Zeng

$$\tilde{I}_{r,5} = m_1^2 m_2^2 (m_1^4 + m_2^4) \tilde{I}_{r,5}^{0\text{SF}} + m_1^3 m_2^3 (m_1^2 + m_2^2) \tilde{I}_{r,5}^{1\text{SF}} + m_1^4 m_2^4 \tilde{I}_{r,5}^{2\text{SF}}$$



- While Calabi-Yau drops out they complicate the solution.
- We know it drops out because the boundary condition from DE drops out.
- Easier to use series solution



Scattering angle:  $\chi = -\frac{\partial I_r}{\partial J}$

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{I}_{r,5}^{2\text{SF,fin.}} = & -\frac{3}{320\bar{\sigma}^4} + \frac{31}{160\bar{\sigma}^3} - \frac{3543}{640\bar{\sigma}^2} - \frac{142651}{1920\bar{\sigma}} - \frac{22066709}{230400} + \dots \\ & - \pi^2 \left( \frac{41}{64\bar{\sigma}} + \frac{9523}{1152} + \frac{44005\bar{\sigma}}{2304} + \dots \right) \end{aligned}$$

22 terms explicitly given in paper

**Plefka et al:**  
 analytic expressions + conservative radiative part  
 A good way to separate conservative from  
 dissipative is still lacking.

**The way Elliptic and Calabi-Yau integrals drop out seems mysterious.**



# Can we get to 6PM?

**More immediate question: Can we banish supercomputers at 5PM?**

- **Very fast progress though 4 PM (~1 day modest cluster, public codes).**
  - No Integration bottleneck. Many order of magnitude simpler than 5PM.
  - FIRE6 or KIRA2 available for collider physics scattering amplitudes
- **Progress slowed at 5PM because integrals beyond ability of public IBP codes.**
  - **Upgraded IBP programs: FIRE7 and KIRA3, revamped algorithms, better seeding.**

FIRE7: Smirnov, Zeng; KIRA3: Lang, Usovitsch, Wu

**Progress feeds back to collider physics!**

**Recent progress:**

- 1) **Better IBP seeding using mass dimension cutoff.**
  - Targeted “bottleneck integrals” become “simple”.
  - Much more progress on seeding possible.
- 2) **Latch onto UV and IR properties. Example of a completely different approach.**

**Banishing supercomputers seems feasible.**



# Example of New Approach

ZB, Jackman, Mansfield, Ruf

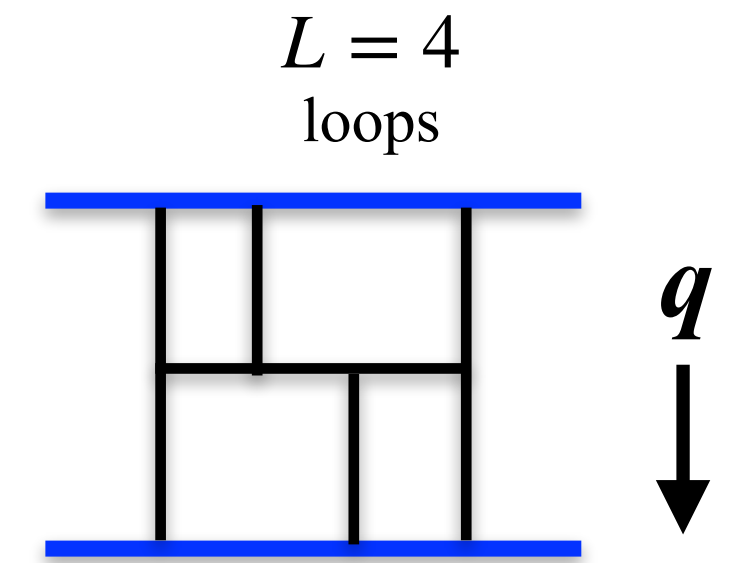
Why does elliptic cancel and CY cancel? Complete mystery via IBP.  
There should be a better way to do the integrals!

In the conservative sector the scattering amplitudes at  $L$  loops behave as

$$\mathcal{M}_{\text{cl}} \sim \begin{cases} (-q^2)^{\frac{L}{2}-1} \ln(-q^2), & L \text{ even} \\ (-q^2)^{\frac{L}{2}-1}, & L \text{ odd.} \end{cases}$$

$q$  is the momentum transfer

$$V(r) \sim \frac{1}{r^{L+1}}$$



In dim. reg, the only source of  $\ln(-q^2)$  are divergences

divergence:

→  $\frac{1}{\epsilon} (-q^2)^{-L\epsilon} = \left[ \frac{1}{\epsilon} - L \ln(-q^2) + \mathcal{O}(\epsilon) \right] \quad D = 4 - 2\epsilon$

- Diverge structure is *completely ignored* in the standard IBP approach.
- IBP can scramble IR and UV and introduces spurious divergences.

Key observation: Singular regions generally much easier to calculate than nonsingular regions



# Exploiting UV Structure

Test of the idea:

1) Reproduced 2 loop (3PM) conservative results. IBP methods not challenging here.

2) Can we explain missing Calabi-Yau and Elliptic integrals at 5PM?

Two loop (3PM) example:

$$q \downarrow \quad \begin{array}{c} \ell_1 \\ \ell_2 \end{array} \quad \text{Diagram} = \int \frac{d^D \ell_1 d^D \ell_2}{(i\pi^{D/2})^2} \frac{\delta(2u_1 \cdot \ell_1) \delta(2u_2 \cdot \ell_2) \mathcal{N}}{\ell_1^2 \ell_2^2 (\ell_1 - q)^2 (\ell_2 - q)^2 (\ell_1 + \ell_2 - q)^2}$$

UV region

$$\ell_1, \ell_2 \gg q$$

$$\begin{array}{c} \ell_1 \\ \ell_2 \end{array} \quad \text{Diagram} \Big|_{\text{UV}} = \begin{array}{c} \text{Cusp Diagram} \Big|_{\text{UV}} = \frac{i\pi \operatorname{arccosh}(\sigma)(i\pi - \operatorname{arccosh}(\sigma))}{\epsilon \, 2\sqrt{\sigma^2 - 1}}$$

UV divergence

$$(\ell_1 + q)^2 \rightarrow \ell_1^2$$

- In UV region integral simplifies into a cusp integral.
- Integrals simpler.
- Reproduces 3PM results

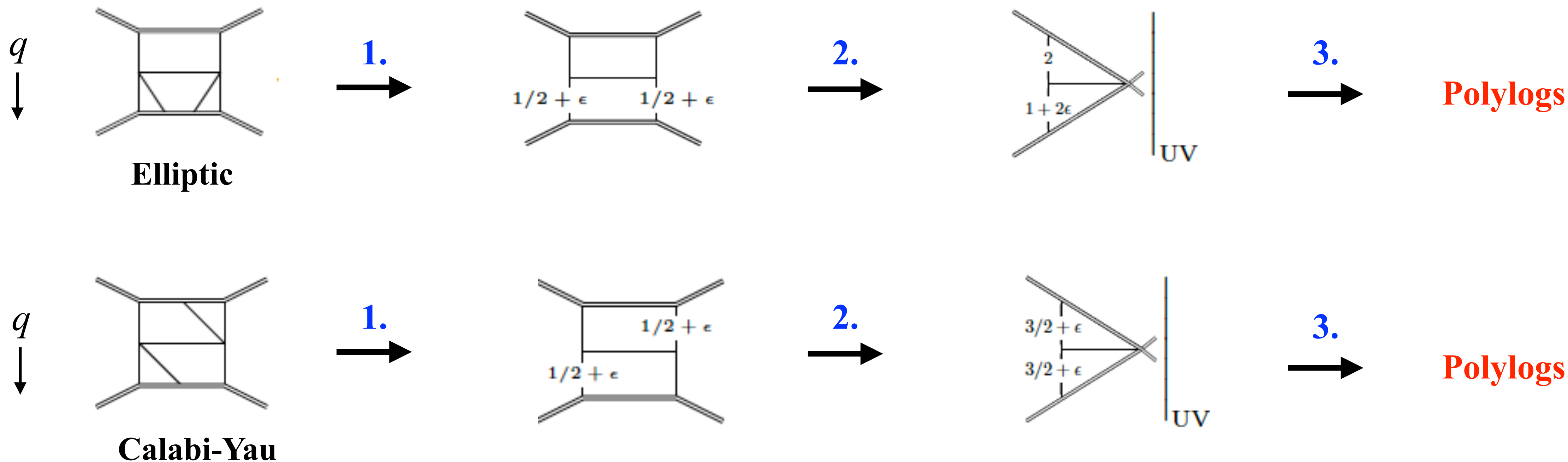
# Integrals simplify greatly in the UV

1. Integrate out triangle subdiagrams.

$$D = 4 - 2\epsilon$$

2. Take UV limit:  $\ell_i \gg q$ .  $(\ell_1 + q)^2 \rightarrow \ell_1^2$

3. Integrate simpler UV integral (See Appendix of arXiv: )



We see that elliptic and CY not present in conservative part. (Heun remains).

We are currently seeing how far this can be pushed.



# Many Aspects Not Discussed Here

I only discussed spinless, no tidal, no absorption. Other aspects:

- **Pushing state of the art for high orders in  $G$**   
ZB, Cheung, Roiban, Parra-Martinez, Ruf, Shen, Solon, Zeng; ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Smith, Zeng; Damgaard, Plante, Vanhove; etc
- **Waveforms**  
Cristofoli, Gonzo, Kosower, O'Connell; Herrmann, Parra-Martinez, Ruf, Zeng; Di Vecchia, Heissenberg, Russo, Veneziano; Herderschee, Roiban, Teng; Georgoudis, Heissenberg, Vazquez-Holm; Brandhuber, Brown, Chen, De Angelis, Gowdy, Travaglini; De Angelis, Gonzo, Novichkov, Alaverdian, ZB, Kosmopoulos, Luna, RR, Scheopner, Teng; Bohnenblust, Ita, Kraus, Schlenk; Brunello, De Angelo, Kosower; etc
- **Finite-size effects**  
Cheung and Solon; Haddad and Helset; Kälin, Liu, Porto; Cheung, Shah, Solon; ZB, Parra-Martinez, Roiban, Sawyer, Shen; etc
- **Spin**  
Vaidya; Porto; Levi, Steinhoff; Geuvara, O'Connell, Vines; Chung, Huang, Kim, Lee; ZB, Luna, Roiban, Shen, Zeng; Mogull, Plefka, Steinhoff; Kosmopoulos, Luna; Febres Cordero, Kraus, Lin, Ruf, Zeng; Aoude Haddad, Helset; ZB, Kosmopoulos, Luna, Roiban, Scheopner, Teng, Vines; Cangemi, Chiodaroli, Johansson, Ochirov, Pichini, Skvortsov; Gatica; Luna, Moynihan, O'Connell, Ross; Akpinar, Febres Cordero, Kraus, Ruf, Zeng; Bautista, Guevara, Kavanagh, Vines; etc.
- **Absorption**  
Jones and Ruf, Chen, Hsieh, Y-t Huang, J-W Kim; Bautista, Guevara, Kavanagh, Vines; etc
- **Renormalization Effects**  
Goldberger and Rothstein; Goldberger, Ross; Porto, Galley, Leibovich; Levi; Barack, ZB, Herrmann, Long, Parra-Martinez, Roiban, Ruf, Shen, Solon, Teng, Ivanov, Li, Parra-Martinez, Zhou; Caron-Huot, Correia, Isabella, Solon, etc

The standard quantities of interest for the inspiral phase of binary black holes can be computed in amplitudes approach. A lot of work remains!

# Summary

- Pushing state of the art: real progress on 5PM . “Conservative” part under control.
- Progress is slower now that we are beyond reach standard IBP tools.
- New ideas and methods for tackling integrals
  - Better IBP seeding. Recent vast improvements. More possible.
  - UV, IR analysis is one new idea, at least for certain classes of integrals, including 5PM “conservative”.
  - Elliptic and CY integral cancellations explained.
- 5PM radiative, dissipative contributions under study.
- Longer term goal is 6PM. First need to banish supercomputers from 5PM.

**5PM is difficult but coming under control.**



**EXTRA**

# Systematically Correcting Newton's Potential

For orbital mechanics:

Expand in  $G$  and  $v^2$

$$v^2 \sim \frac{GM}{R} \ll 1$$

virial theorem



In center of mass frame:

$$m = m_A + m_B, \quad \nu = \mu/M,$$

$$\mu = m_A m_B / m, \quad P_R = P \cdot \hat{R}$$

$$\frac{H}{\mu} = \frac{P^2}{2} - \frac{Gm}{R} \quad \leftarrow \text{Newton}$$

$$+ \frac{1}{c^2} \left\{ -\frac{P^4}{8} + \frac{3\nu P^4}{8} + \frac{Gm}{R} \left( -\frac{P_R^2 \nu}{2} - \frac{3P^2}{2} - \frac{\nu P^2}{2} \right) + \frac{G^2 m^2}{2R^2} \right\}$$

+ ...

1PN: Einstein, Infeld, Hoffmann;  
Droste, Lorentz

Hamiltonian known to 4PN order.

2PN: Ohta, Okamura, Kimura and Hiida.

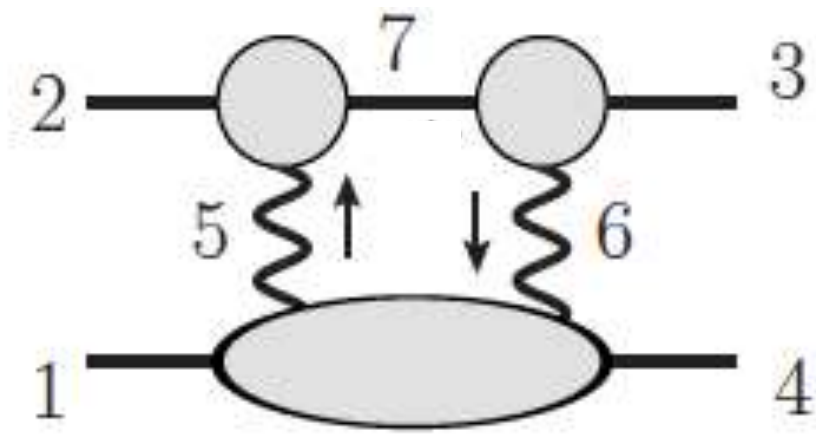
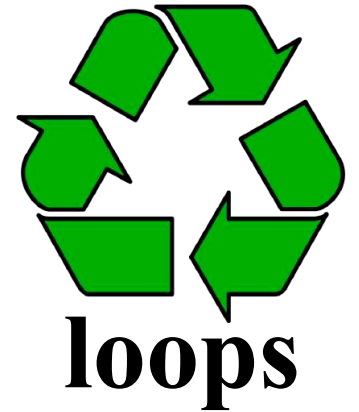
3PN: Damour, Jaranowski and Schaefer; L. Blanchet and G. Faye.

4PN: Damour, Jaranowski and Schaefer; Foffa (2017), Porto, Rothstein, Sturani (2019).



# Generalized Unitarity Cuts

- Higher-order gravity (loops) from lower order (tree) amplitudes.
- Gravity tree amplitudes from gauge-theory ones.



2<sup>nd</sup> post-Minkowskian order

$$\begin{aligned}
 C_{\text{GR}} &= \sum_{h_5, h_6 = \pm} M_3^{\text{tree}}(3^s, 6^{h_6}, -7^s) M_3^{\text{tree}}(7^s, -5^{h_5}, 2^s) M_4^{\text{tree}}(1^s, 5^{-h_5}, -6^{-h_6}, 4^s) \quad \leftarrow \text{gravity tree amplitudes} \\
 &= \sum_{h_5, h_6 = \pm} it [A_3^{\text{tree}}(3^s, 6^{h_6}, -7^s) A_3^{\text{tree}}(7^s, -5^{h_5}, 2^s) A_4^{\text{tree}}(1^s, 5^{-h_5}, -6^{-h_6}, 4^s)] \\
 &\quad \times [A_3^{\text{tree}}(3^s, 6^{h_6}, -7^s) A_3^{\text{tree}}(7^s, -5^{h_5}, 2^s) A_4^{\text{tree}}(4^s, 5^{-h_5}, -6^{-h_6}, 1^s)] \quad \swarrow \text{gauge theory amplitudes}
 \end{aligned}$$

- Note: Calculations start from gauge theory not gravity.
- This is then appropriately integrated and processed to give observable

# EXTRA

Issues to consider.

Should we keep the slide on the detectability

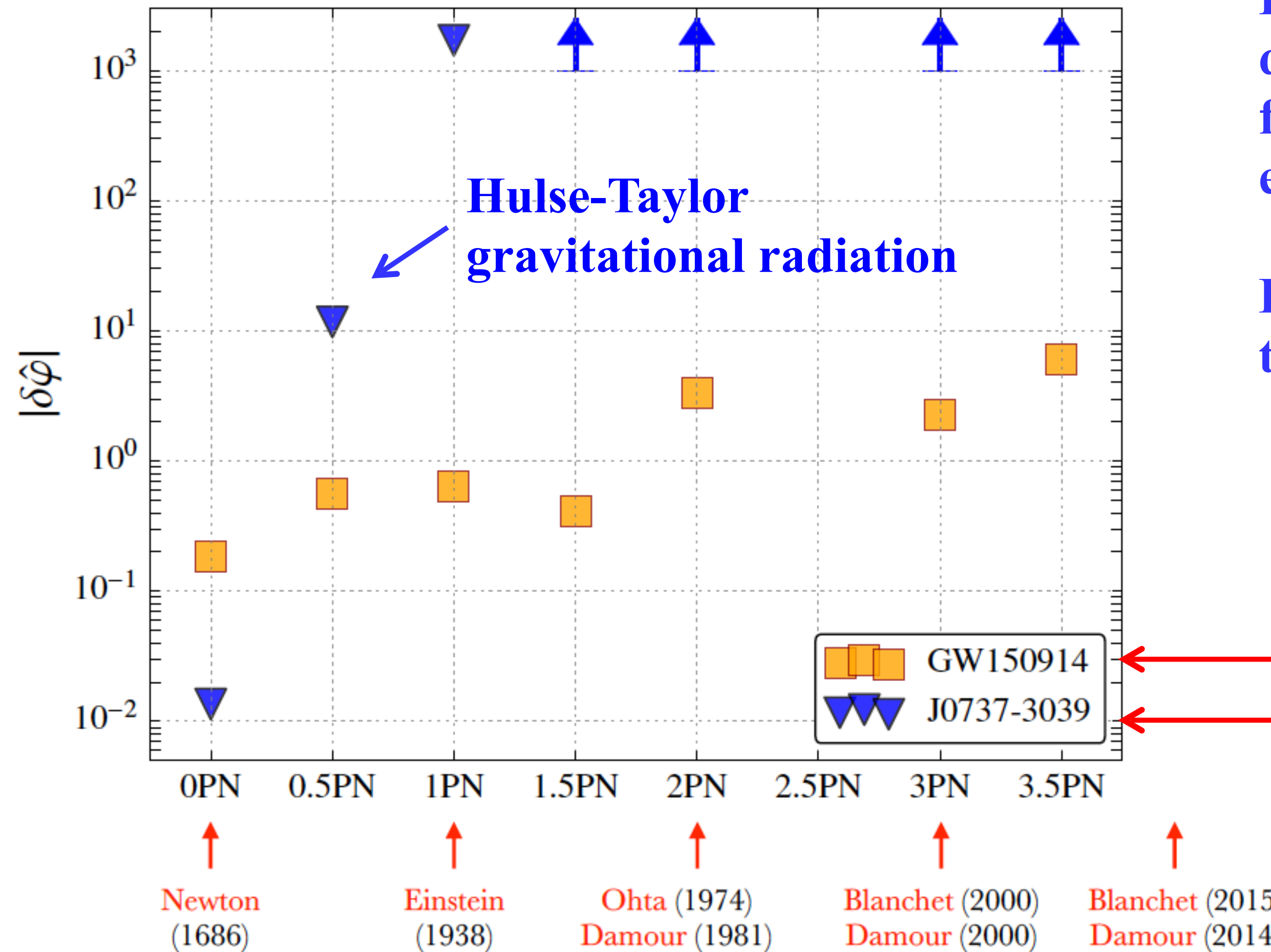
Is there too much double copy.

Reduce emphasis on the last part.



# Importance of higher orders for LIGO/Virgo

LIGO/Virgo Collaboration arXiv:1602.03841



Binary pulsar confirms quadrupole radiation formula and not much else.

LIGO/Virgo tests PN terms from GR

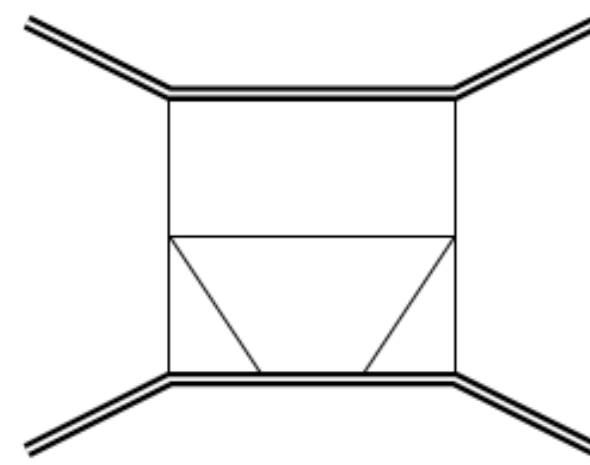
LIGO  
Binary pulsar

**LIGO/Virgo sensitive to high PN orders.**

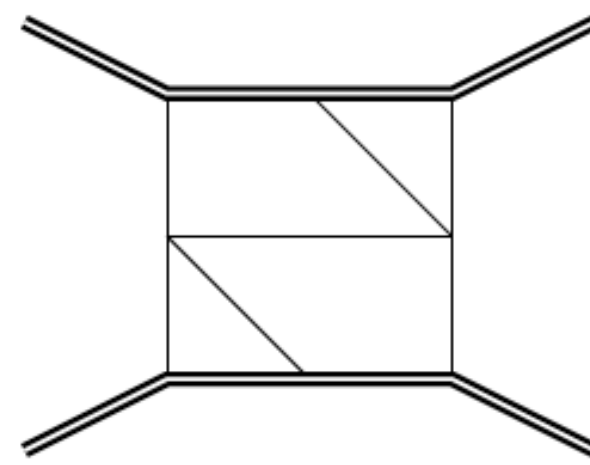
# Source of Calabi-Yau, Elliptic and Heun

Integration facts we exploit:

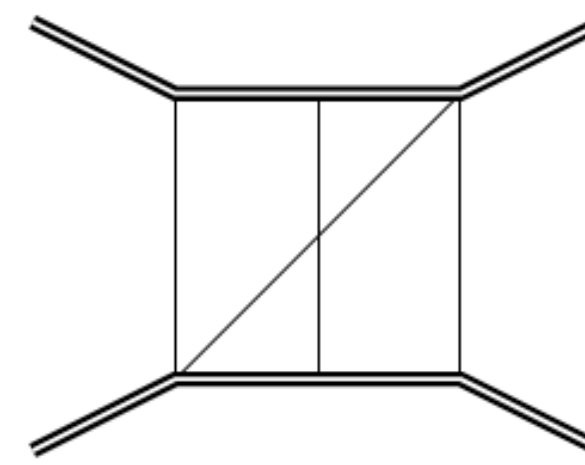
- The special functions beyond GPLs are controlled by only 3 sources:



Elliptic



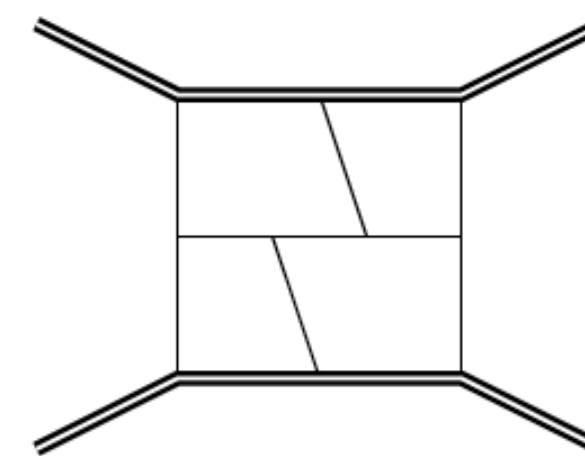
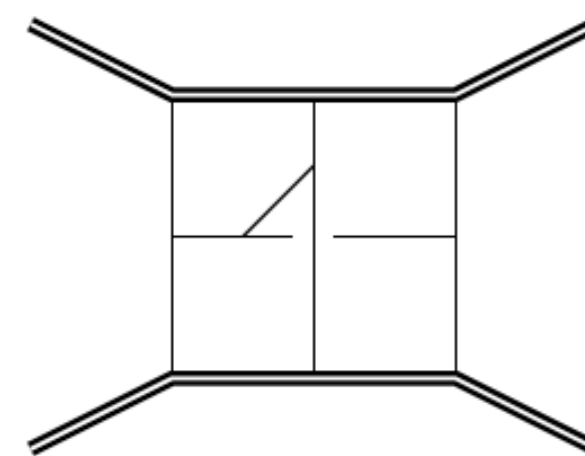
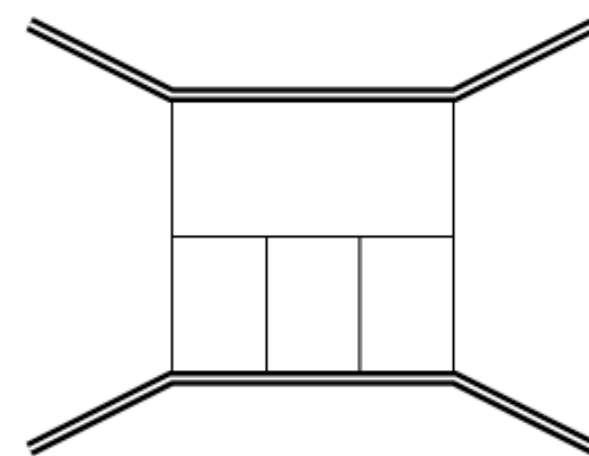
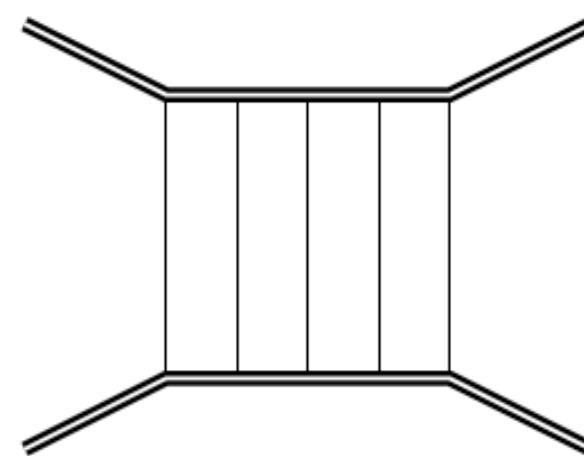
Calabi-Yau



Heun

These are the diagrams to focus on

- Above diagrams have only UV divergences, no IR
- Maximal cut analysis shows above diagrams must be present for functions beyond GPLS



**Task: Determine what happens to the Elliptic, CY and Heun in the UV limit.**



# What are we after?



- Physical observables directly.
- When possible, replace scattering in general relativity with a two-body Hamiltonian that is easy to use in bound-state problem.

- $$V(\mathbf{r}, \mathbf{p}) = -\frac{Gm_1m_2}{r} + \dots$$

want correction terms

**Similar to Newton's potential, except:**

- Compatible with special relativity (all orders in velocity)
- Eventually valid through  $O(G^6)$ .

Alessandra Buonanno  
(AEI, Potsdam)

# To Meet Challenge: GWSky Project

Zvi Bern (UCLA)



Gravitational-wave  
modeling, interpretation

Non-linear strong  
field dynamics, radiation



Maarten van de Meent  
Bohr Institute, Copenhagen



Collider physics,  
black-hole scattering

Black-hole environments,  
beyond General Relativity



Enrico Barausse  
SISSA, Trieste.



Funded by  
the European Union



European Research Council  
Established by the European Commission



# PN versus PM expansion for conservative two-body dynamics

From Buonanno  
Amplitudes 2018

$$\mathcal{L} = -Mc^2 + \underbrace{\frac{\mu v^2}{2} + \frac{GM\mu}{r}}_{\downarrow} + \frac{1}{c^2} [\dots] + \frac{1}{c^4} [\dots] + \dots$$

$$E(v) = -\frac{\mu}{2} v^2 + \dots$$

non-spinning compact objects

|      |   | 0PN   | 1PN     | 2PN       | 3PN       | 4PN       | 5PN        | ... |
|------|---|-------|---------|-----------|-----------|-----------|------------|-----|
| 0PM: | 1 | $v^2$ | $v^4$   | $v^6$     | $v^8$     | $v^{10}$  | $v^{12}$   | ... |
| 1PM: |   | $1/r$ | $v^2/r$ | $v^4/r$   | $v^6/r$   | $v^8/r$   | $v^{10}/r$ | ... |
| 2PM: |   |       | $1/r^2$ | $v^2/r^2$ | $v^4/r^2$ | $v^6/r^2$ | $v^8/r^2$  | ... |
| 3PM: |   |       |         | $1/r^3$   | $v^2/r^3$ | $v^4/r^3$ | $v^6/r^3$  | ... |
| 4PM: |   |       |         |           | $1/r^4$   | $v^2/r^4$ | $v^4/r^4$  | ... |
| ...  |   |       |         |           |           | ...       | ...        |     |

(credit: Justin Vines)

current known  
PN results

$1 \rightarrow Mc^2,$   
current known  
PM results

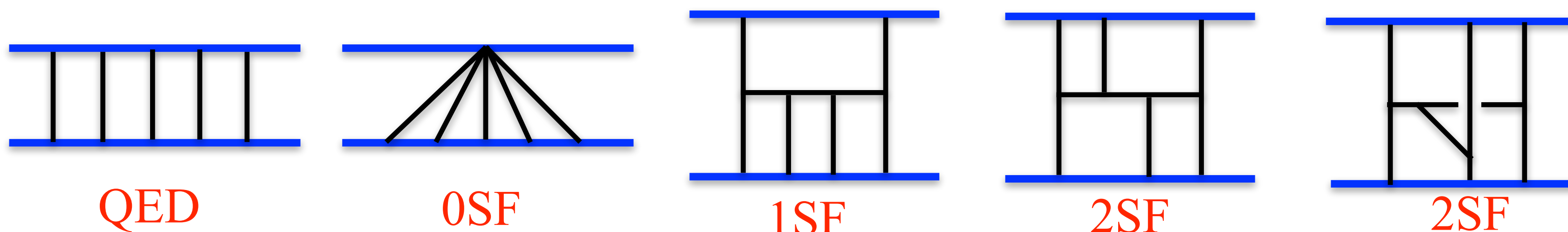
$v^2 \rightarrow \frac{v^2}{c^2},$   
overlap between  
PN & PM results

unknown

- **PM results** (Westfahl 79, Westfahl & Goller 80, Portilla 79-80, Bel et al. 81, Ledvinka et al. 10, Damour 16-17, Guevara 17, Vines 17, Bini & Damour 17-18, Vines in prep)



# Deal With Integration in Stages



Stages:

1. QED warmup. Potential mode contributions.

Done.

ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng

2. 1 SF Conservative.

Done.

Driesse, Jakobsen, Mogull, Plefka, Sauer, Usovitsch

3.  $N = 8$  sugra(lower tensor rank)

Both 1SF and 2SF potential done.

ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng

4. 2 SF Conservative.

Hard, but definitely in reach.

5. Radiative effects.

Similar

$$M_{5\text{PM}} = M_{5\text{PM}}^{0\text{SF}} + \nu M_{5\text{PM}}^{1\text{SF}} + \nu^2 M_{\text{PM}}^{2\text{SF}}$$

$$\nu = \frac{m_1 m_2}{(m_1 + m_2)^2}$$

Learn from each stage to push forward the next one.

# High Loop Integration

**In QCD/Amplitudes advanced technology for loop integrals which we import.**

**1. IBP greatly simplified in classical limit.**

Chetyrkin, Tkachov; Laporta; Henn; Henn and Smirnov  
Beneke and Smirnov; Parra-Martinez, Ruf, Zeng

**2. Choose master integrals to simplify the DEs and IBP.**

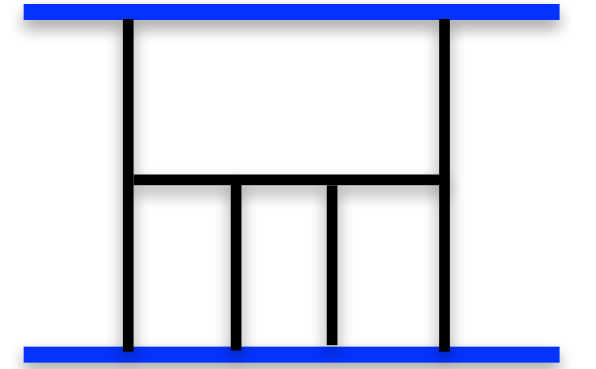
A. Smirnov and V. Smirnov; Usovitsch

**3. Use finite prime fields and reconstruction for toughest IBPs.**

Manteuffel, Schabinger; Peraro

**4. Set up a DEs for master integrals.**

Kotikov, ZB, Dixon and Kosower; Gehrmann, Remiddi



**IBP:** 
$$0 = \int \prod_i^L \frac{d^D \ell_i}{(2\pi)^D} \frac{\partial}{\partial \ell_i^\mu} \frac{N^\mu(\ell_k, p_M)}{Z_1 \dots Z_n}$$
 **Solve linear relations for master integrals**

**DEs:** 
$$\partial_x \vec{I} = A(x, \epsilon) \vec{I}, \quad \partial_x \vec{J} = \epsilon B(x) \vec{J}, \quad \vec{J} = T(\epsilon, x) \vec{I}$$
 **Solve DEs either as series or basis of functions.**

**Many tools available: We use upgraded FIRE, a private finite field IBP program, LiteRed, FiniteFlow.**

Smirnov, Chuharev; Lee; Peraro

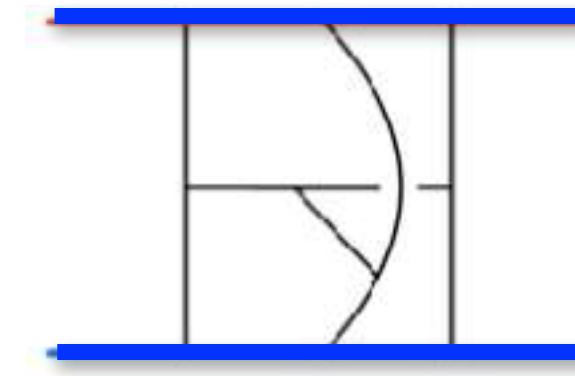
**Another important tool is an upgraded version of KIRA**

Maierhoefer, Usovitsch, Uwer;  
Klappert, Lange, Maierhöfer, Usovitsch



# Bottleneck: Integral Reduction

Primary bottleneck is integration by parts:



22 indices: 13 propagator and 9 irreducible scalar products (ISPs)

$$\int \frac{d^4 k [u_2 \cdot k_1]^{a-14} [u_2 \cdot k_4]^{a-15} [u_1 \cdot k_2]^{a-16} [u_1 \cdot k_3]^{a-17} [k_1 \cdot q]^{a-18} [k_2 \cdot q]^{a-19} [k_1 \cdot k_2]^{a-20} [k_1 \cdot k_4]^{a-21} [k_2 \cdot k_3]^{a-22}}{[-2u_2 \cdot k_2]^{a_1} [-2u_2 \cdot k_{123}]^{a_2} [2u_1 \cdot k_{234}]^{a_3} [2u_1 \cdot k_{1234}]^{a_4} [k_1^2]^{a_5} [k_2^2]^{a_6} [k_3^2]^{a_7} [k_{13}^2]^{a_8} [k_4^2]^{a_9} [k_{34}^2]^{a_{10}} [k_{234}^2]^{a_{11}} [(k_{123} - q)^2]^{a_{12}} [(k_{1234} - q)^2]^{a_{13}}}$$

Very similar to wordline integrals. KMOC version gives identical integrand as WLQFT

- Can encounter up to 8 numerator powers and 4 doubled propagators.
- FIRE and KIRA need to be carefully tuned.
- Private code specialized for finite field numerical techniques.

$$0 = \int \prod_i^L \frac{d^D \ell_i}{(2\pi)^D} \frac{\partial}{\partial \ell_i^\mu} \frac{N^\mu(\ell_k, p_i)}{D_1^{a_1} \cdots D_n^{a_n}}$$

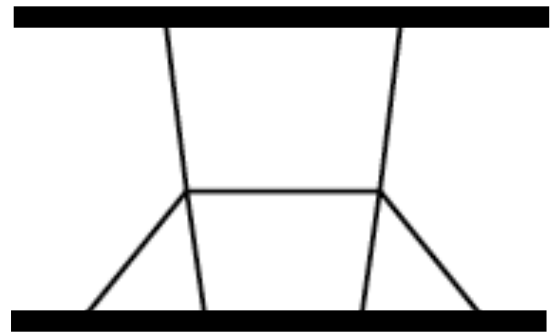
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng;

Driesse, Jakobsen, Mogull, Plefka, Sauer, Usovitsch

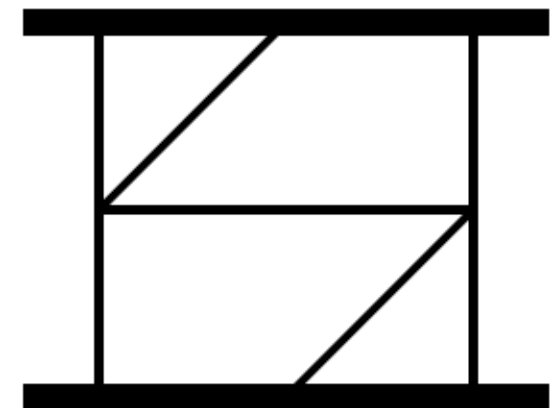
# Iterated integrals

Elliptic and Calabi-Yau integrals appear in master integrals.

Frellesvig, Morales, Wilhelm; Klemm, Nega, Sauer, Plefka  
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng.



At 1 SF, Elliptic integrals.



At 2 SF, Calabi-Yau 3-fold integrals.

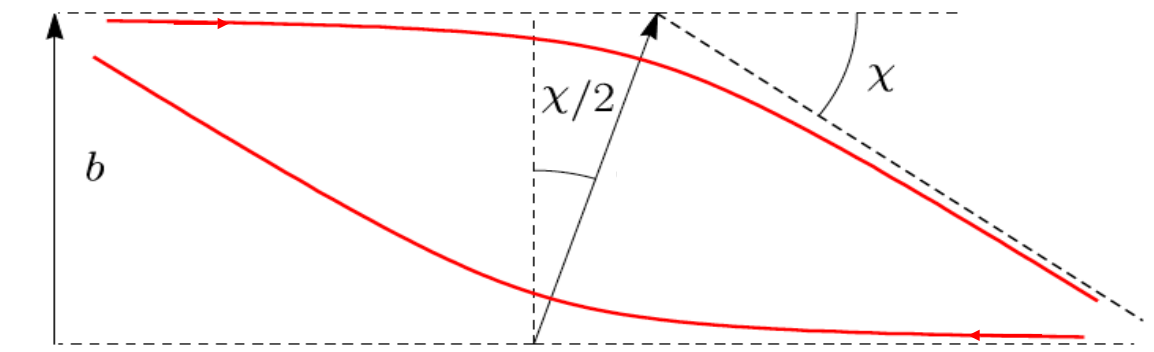
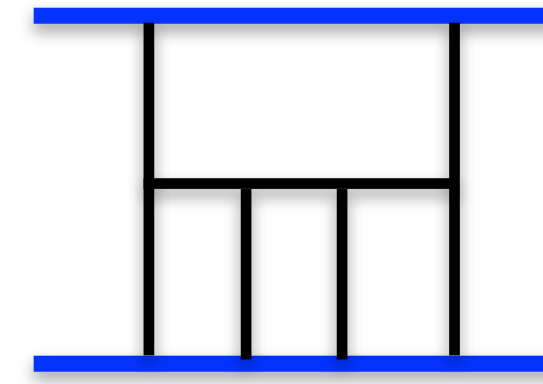
- At 1SF no elliptic integrals in final result!
- Will this simplicity continue to 2 SF sector?

Opportunity for those interested in the mathematics of Feynman integrals



# 5PM Scattering Angle $N = 8$ Supergravity (1SF Potential)

ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng



$$\tilde{I}_{r,5}^{1\text{SF},\text{fin.}} = r_1 + r_2 F_0 + r_3 F_0^2 + r_4 F_1 + r_5 F_2.$$

Cyclotomic polylogs are natural functions to use,  
but here only up to dilogs. Ablinger, Bluemlein, Schneider.

$$F_0 = \frac{2x}{1-x^2} \ln(x),$$

$$F_1 = \frac{2x}{1-x^2} \left[ -\text{Li}_2(1-x) - \text{Li}_2(-x) - \ln(x) \ln(x+1) - \frac{1}{2} \zeta_2 \right],$$

$$F_2 = \frac{2x}{1-x^2} \left[ -\text{Li}_2(1-x) + \text{Li}_2(-x) - \frac{1}{2} \ln^2(x) + \ln(x) \ln(x+1) + \frac{1}{2} \zeta_2 \right]$$

**Remarkably simple, elliptic integrals cancel.**

$$r_1 = \frac{16c_\phi^3}{\sigma^2-1} \left[ -\frac{\sigma(5\sigma^2-4)c_\phi^3}{5(\sigma^2-1)^3} - \frac{2c_\phi^2}{\sigma^2-1} + 8 \right],$$

$$r_2 = 32c_\phi^2 \left[ -\frac{\sigma^2 c_\phi^4}{(\sigma^2-1)^3} - \frac{4\sigma c_\phi^3}{(\sigma^2-1)^2} - \frac{9(2\sigma^2-1)c_\phi^2}{2(\sigma^2-1)^2} - \frac{8\sigma c_\phi}{\sigma^2-1} + 1 \right],$$

$$r_3 = 16c_\phi \left[ -\frac{\sigma^3 c_\phi^5}{(\sigma^2-1)^3} - \frac{6\sigma^2 c_\phi^4}{(\sigma^2-1)^2} + \frac{6\sigma(2-3\sigma^2)c_\phi^3}{(\sigma^2-1)^2} + \frac{(8-32\sigma^2)c_\phi^2}{\sigma^2-1} - \frac{92\sigma c_\phi}{3} - \frac{40}{3}(\sigma^2-1) \right],$$

$$r_4 = 32c_\phi \left[ -\frac{\sigma c_\phi^3}{(\sigma^2-1)^2} - \frac{2c_\phi^2}{\sigma^2-1} - \frac{4\sigma c_\phi}{3(\sigma^2-1)} - \frac{8}{3} \right],$$

$$r_5 = 64c_\phi \left[ \frac{\sigma^2 c_\phi^3}{(\sigma^2-1)^2} + \frac{4\sigma c_\phi^2}{\sigma^2-1} + \frac{2(7\sigma^2-6)c_\phi}{3(\sigma^2-1)} + \frac{4\sigma}{3} \right].$$

**See also very nice GR 1SF conservative results.**

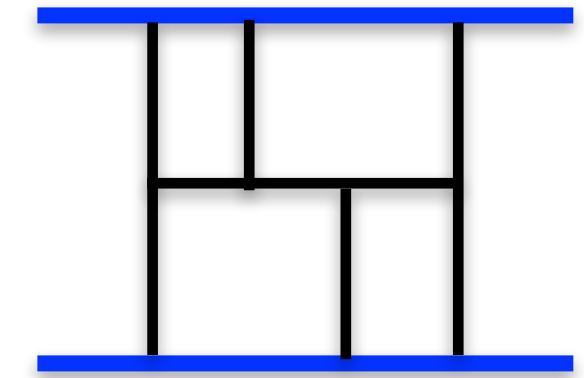
Driesse, Jakobsen, Mogull, Plefka, Sauer, Usovitsch

**Scattering angle:**  $\chi = -\frac{\partial I_r}{\partial J}$

**Very encouraging that results are so simple**

# 5PM Scattering Angle $N = 8$ Supergravity (2SF Potential)

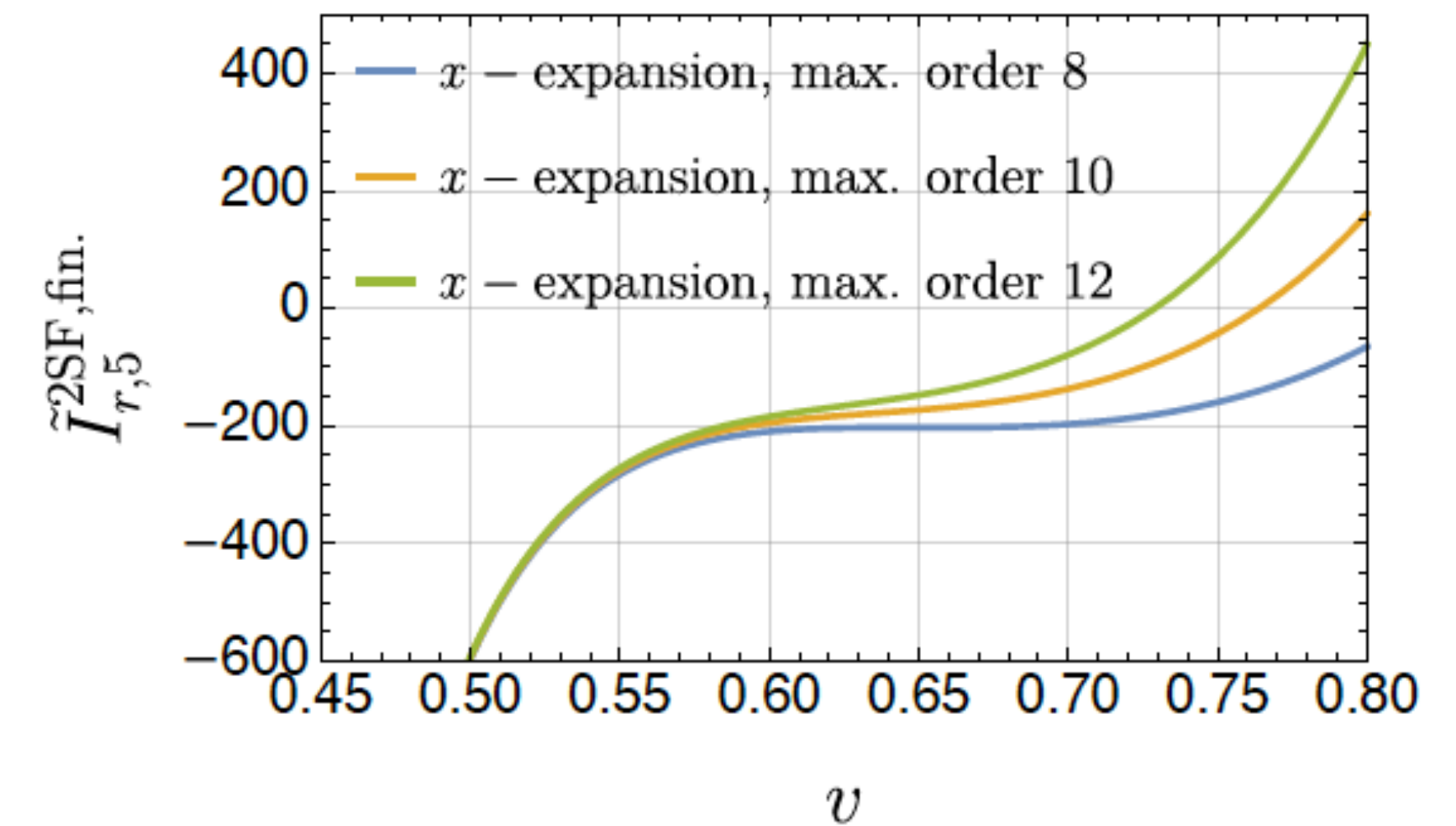
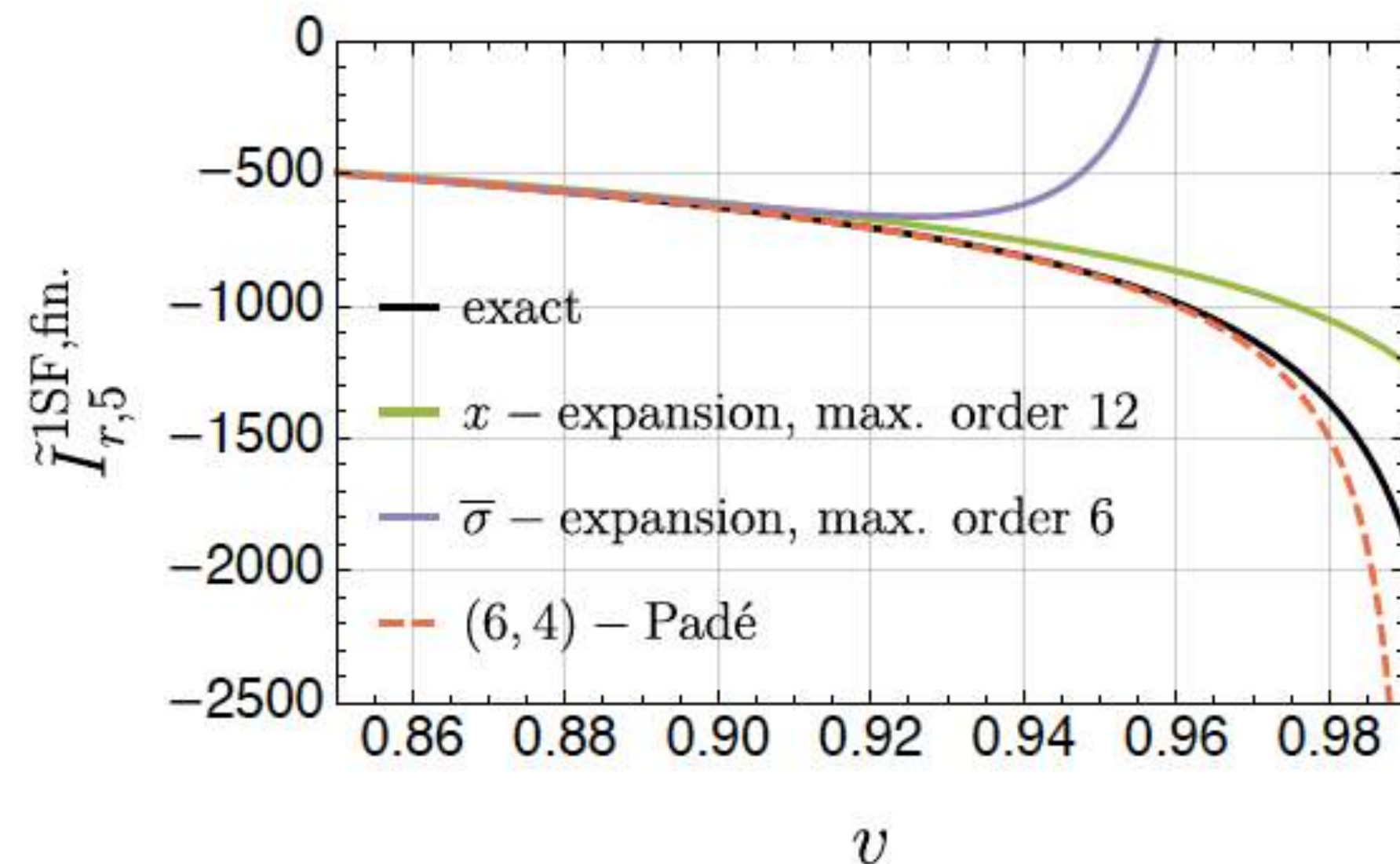
ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng



For 2SF Calabi-Yau integrals complicate analytic solution, use series solution

$$\tilde{I}_{r,5}^{2\text{SF,fn.}} = 16c_\phi \left[ c_\phi^5 \left( -\frac{3}{160\bar{\sigma}^4} + \frac{1}{80\bar{\sigma}^3} + \dots \right) + c_\phi^4 \left( -\frac{4}{3\bar{\sigma}} + \frac{38}{45} + \dots \right) + c_\phi^3 \left( -\frac{121}{18\bar{\sigma}} - \frac{5933}{1800} + \dots \right) \right. \\ \left. + c_\phi^2 \left( -\frac{12}{\bar{\sigma}} - \frac{370}{9} + \dots \right) + c_\phi^1 \left( -\frac{302}{3} + \frac{1016\bar{\sigma}}{45} + \dots \right) + c_\phi^0 \left( -\frac{296\bar{\sigma}}{3} + \frac{76\bar{\sigma}^2}{5} + \dots \right) \right]$$

Worked out 10 orders



Expect series solutions should be fine for practical purposes



# Outlook

Amplitude methods have already contributed to many aspects of theory of gravitational waves.

- **Pushing state of the art for high orders in  $G$**   
ZB, Cheung, Roiban, Parra-Martinez, Ruf, Shen, Solon, Zeng; ZB, Herrmann, Roiban, Ruf, Smirnov, Smirnov, Zeng; Damgaard, Plante, Vanhove; etc
- **Waveforms**  
Cristofoli, Gonzo, Kosower, O'Connell; Herrmann, Parra-Martinez, Ruf, Zeng; Di Vecchia, Heissenberg, Russo, Veneziano; Herderschee, Roiban, Teng; Georgoudis, Heissenberg, Vazquez-Holm; Brandhuber, Brown, Chen, De Angelis, Gowdy. Travaglini; De Angelis, Gonzo, Novichkov, Alaverdian, ZB, Kosmopoulos, Luna, RR, Scheopner, Teng; Bohnenblust, Ita, Kraus, Schlenk; etc
- **Finite-size effects**  
Cheung and Solon; Haddad and Helset; Kälin, Liu, Porto; Cheung, Shah, Solon; ZB, Parra-Martinez, Roiban, Sawyer, Shen; etc
- **Spin**  
Vaidya; Geuvara, O'Connell, Vines; Chung, Huang, Kim, Lee; ZB, Luna, Roiban, Shen, Zeng; Kosmopoulos, Luna; Febres Cordero, Kraus, Lin, Ruf, Zeng; Aoude Haddad, Helset; ZB, Kosmopoulos, Luna, Roiban, Scheopner, Teng, Vines; Cangemi, Chiodaroli, Johansson, Ochirov, Pichini, Skvortsov; Akpinar, Febres Cordero, Kraus, Ruf, Zeng; Bautista, Guevara, Kavanagh, Vines; etc.
- **Absorption**  
Jones and Ruf, Chen, Hsieh, Y-t Huang, J-W Kim; Bautista, Guevara, Kavanagh, Vines; etc

The standard quantities of interest for the inspiral phase can be computed in amplitudes framework. Formalism is far from exhausted.



# Summary

- Scattering amplitudes give us new ways to think about certain problems of current interest in general relativity.
- Feynman's approach: massless spin-2 gravitons all you need to derive GR.
- Double-copy idea gives a *unified framework* for gravity and gauge theory.
- Combining with EFT methods gives a powerful tool for gravitational-wave physics.
- Pushing state of the art: heading to  $O(G^5)$ .
- GWSky Project Goal: Combine with other methods to meet precision challenge.
- Various directions: higher orders in  $G$ , resummations in  $G$ , spin, finite-size effects, radiation and dissipation.

**Amplitudes viewpoint that gravity and gauge theory belong together is powerful.**

**Expect much more progress in the coming years.**